



Mark Scheme (Results)

June 2026

Pearson Edexcel International GCSE in

English Literature (4ET1)

Paper 2: Modern Drama and Literary Heritage Texts

Edexcel and BTEC Qualifications

Edexcel and BTEC qualifications are awarded by Pearson, the UK's largest awarding body. We provide a wide range of qualifications including academic, vocational, occupational and specific programmes for employers. For further information visit our qualifications websites at www.edexcel.com or www.btec.co.uk. Alternatively, you can get in touch with us using the details on our contact us page at www.edexcel.com/contactus

Pearson: helping people progress, everywhere

Pearson aspires to be the world's leading learning company. Our aim is to help everyone progress in their lives through education. We believe in every kind of learning, for all kinds of people, wherever they are in the world. We've been involved in education for over 150 years, and by working across 70 countries, in 100 languages, we have built an international reputation for our commitment to high standards and raising achievement through innovation in education. Find out more about how we can help you and your students at:

www.pearson.com/uk

Summer 2026

Question Paper Log Number P79513A

Publication Code 4ET1_02_2606_MS

All the material in this publication is copyright

© Pearson

General Marking Guidance

- All candidates must receive the same treatment. Examiners must mark the first candidate in exactly the same way as they mark the last.
- Mark schemes should be applied positively. Candidates must be rewarded for what they have shown they can do rather than penalised for omissions.
- Examiners should mark according to the mark scheme not according to their perception of where the grade boundaries may lie.
- There is no ceiling on achievement. All marks on the mark scheme should be used appropriately.
- All the marks on the mark scheme are designed to be awarded. Examiners should always award full marks if deserved, i.e. if the answer matches the mark scheme. Examiners should also be prepared to award zero marks if the candidate's response is not worthy of credit according to the mark scheme.
- Where some judgement is required, mark schemes will provide the principles by which marks will be awarded and exemplification may be limited.
- When examiners are in doubt regarding the application of the mark scheme to a candidate's response, the team leader must be consulted.
- Crossed out work should be marked UNLESS the candidate has replaced it with an alternative response.

Specific Marking Guidance

- When deciding how to reward an answer, examiners should consult both the indicative content and the associated marking grid(s). When using a levels-based mark scheme, the 'best fit' approach should be used.
- Examiners should first decide which descriptor most closely matches the answer and place it in that level.
- The mark awarded within the level will be decided based on the quality of the answer and will be modified according to how securely all bullet points are displayed at that level.
- Indicative content is exactly that – they are factual points that candidates are likely to use to construct their answer.
- It is possible for an answer to be constructed without mentioning some or all of these points, as long as they provide alternative responses to the indicative content that fulfils the requirements of the question. It is the examiner's responsibility to apply their professional judgement to the

candidate's response in determining if the answer fulfils the requirements of the question.

Placing a mark within a level

- Examiners should first decide which descriptor most closely matches the answer and place it in that level. The mark awarded within the level will be decided based on the quality of the answer and will be modified according to how securely all bullet points are displayed at that level.
- In cases of uneven performance, the points above will still apply. Candidates will be placed in the level that best describes their answer according to the descriptors in that level. Marks will be awarded towards the top or bottom of that level depending on how they have evidenced each of the descriptor bullet points.
- If the candidate's answer meets the requirements fully, markers should be prepared to award full marks within the level. The top mark in the level is used for work that is as good as can realistically be expected within that level.

AO1	Demonstrate a close knowledge and understanding of texts, maintaining a critical style and presenting an informed personal engagement.
AO2	Analyse the language, form and structure used by a writer to create meanings and effects.
AO4	Show understanding of the relationships between texts and the contexts in which they were written.

SECTION A – Modern Drama

Question number	Indicative content
1 <i>A View from the Bridge</i>	Examiners should be alert to a variety of responses and should reward points that are clearly based on evidence from the play. Evidence of a degree of personal response must be given. This is not an exhaustive list but the following points may be made: (AO1) - the bridge referred to in the title is significant to the setting of the play as it is the Brooklyn Bridge that is close to the Red Hook community (a slum area): ‘the slum that faces the bay on the seaward side of the Brooklyn Bridge’ - it is a symbol of the link between American and Italian cultures, but also shows the division between them, which is significant to the action of the play - the bridge leads to Manhattan and is symbolic of the pathway of opportunity that lies there as New York’s centre of commerce and luxury - it serves as a significant reminder of American opportunities, success and the American Dream, which is what Marco and Rodolpho seek by coming to America as illegal immigrants - Alfieri is an Italian-American lawyer who views the drama as if from the Brooklyn Bridge. He is an educated, successful observer, and it is his view of the activities taking place in Red Hook that the audience shares - the bridge acts as a division between American law and the traditional laws of the Red Hook community, which is a significant contrast in the play and leads to conflict amongst the characters - Eddie represents someone who is happy to be in the Red Hook side of the bridge as a longshoreman in the shipyards of Brooklyn, whereas Alfieri represents someone more successful and respected who is able to cross the bridge because of his education. He warns Eddie that sometimes it is better to follow natural justice. He later tells Eddie ‘we settle for half’. (AO2) - Language: as a lawyer of Italian extraction, Alfieri acts as a symbolic bridge between the two worlds of poverty and opportunity. He speaks in an educated and controlled dialogue that reflects the opportunities he has had to improve his background: ‘I am inclined to notice the ruins in things because I was born in Italy’. This makes him significantly different from other characters - Language: conversely, Eddie, as a longshoreman, who spends his life loading and unloading boats in the shipyards of Brooklyn, represents someone who is content not to cross the bridge. His failure to improve himself is reflected in his speech: he often does not complete words and runs words together: he says Catherine is ‘walkin’ wavy’ and that men’s heads are ‘turnin’ like windmills’. He uses raw and primitive language, calling Rodolpho ‘weird’ to question his manliness

	• Form: the play is structured like a Greek tragedy with Alfieri acting as the Greek Chorus. He metaphorically stands on the bridge as an onlooker, commenting on events but unable to change them: 'And I sat there many afternoons asking myself why, being an intelligent man, I was so powerless to stop it' • Structure: the bridge is essential to the structure of the play as it is where Alfieri, the narrator and Chorus, reviews events. The play opens and closes with Alfieri looking across the bridge from Red Hook, and it is from here that he makes the final speech of the play • Structure: the dramatic climax of the play occurs when Eddie crosses the metaphorical bridge by breaching the code of his people in Red Hook and resorting to American law by reporting the illegal Italian immigrants.
--	--

Level	Mark	AO1 Demonstrate a close knowledge and understanding of texts, maintaining a critical style and presenting an informed personal engagement. (15 marks) AO2 Analyse the language, form and structure used by a writer to create meanings and effects. (15 marks)
	0	No rewardable material.
Level 1	1–6	• Limited knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response is simple with little evidence of personal engagement or critical style. • Minimal identification of language, form and structure. • Limited use of relevant examples in support.
Level 2	7–12	• Some knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response may be largely narrative with some evidence of personal engagement or critical style. • Some comment on the language, form and structure. • Some use of relevant examples in support.
Level 3	13–18	• Sound knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response shows relevant personal engagement and an appropriate critical style. • Sound understanding of language, form and structure. • Use of clearly relevant examples in support.
Level 4	19–24	• Thorough knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response shows thorough personal engagement and a sustained critical style. • Sustained analysis of language, form and structure. • Use of fully relevant examples in support.
Level 5	25–30	• Assured knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response shows assured personal engagement and a perceptive critical style. • Cohesive evaluation of language, form and structure. • Discriminating use of relevant examples in support.

Question number	Indicative content
2 A View from the Bridge	Examiners should be alert to a variety of responses and should reward points that are clearly based on evidence from the play. Evidence of a degree of personal response must be given. This is not an exhaustive list but the following points may be made: (AO1) • candidates are free to agree or disagree, wholly or in part, with Alfieri's opinion that Eddie's death is 'useless'. Responses should be assessed based on the arguments presented • the death of Eddie could be viewed as 'useless' because it could be avoided and does not solve anything • Alfieri advises Eddie not to inform on Marco and Rodolpho, but Eddie acts hastily out of jealousy and breaks his community's code of honour by betraying members of his own family. This brings about his own death, which could be averted and, therefore, considered 'useless' • Alfieri's view is that 'it is better to settle for half', which means that sometimes natural justice is better than the law. He tells Eddie that it would be unjust to betray the Italians even if he is actually upholding American law by reporting them. If Eddie were to accept the limits of natural justice, he would still be alive • once Eddie has reported Marco and Rodolpho to the authorities, he loses the respect of all who know him and, therefore, has no option but to face Marco in combat. Even Catherine shows that she thinks his behaviour is wrong: 'Nobody is gonna talk to him again if he lives to a hundred' • Eddie thinks that he is saving the family's honour by protecting Catherine from Rodolpho. However, his efforts could be considered useless as in doing so he creates conflict by his vicious attacks on Rodolpho, leading to the loss of respect of both his niece and wife • he pushes Catherine away by being hostile towards Rodolpho and she tells him 'I think I can't stay here no more'. All his efforts to keep control of her prove useless • Eddie takes justice into his own hands, which brings about his downfall. Alfieri tells both Eddie and Marco that the law does not always deliver justice and that sometimes we must leave it to God's will. He tells Marco not to act as Eddie did by using violence against him. He tells him 'Only God makes justice'. Marco initially takes his advice, but Eddie demands an apology from him, which achieves nothing but his own death • at the end, Eddie's death is mourned by both Catherine and Beatrice but family honour has not been restored, so his death has achieved nothing. (AO2) • Language: Eddie's language can be brutal and unpleasant, and his verbal aggression creates conflict, which is unnecessary and useless in solving any family problems. When he orders Rodolpho to leave, after he sees him coming out of Catherine's bedroom, he says 'I take the blankets off my bed for him, and he takes and puts his filthy hands on her like a goddam thief!' His obsessive language drives Catherine away

	• Language: Alfieri uses figurative language when he describes the futility of the workers in Red Hook trying to gain more respect in the community. He says 'This is the gullet of New York swallowing the tonnage of the world'. He shows how most of the people in Red Hook are powerless to change their status regardless of how hard they work • Form/Structure: the play could be viewed as a Greek tragedy with Eddie as the tragic hero and his fatal flaw being his obsessive affection for his niece. Alfieri acts as the Chorus who comments on events but cannot prevent Eddie, the protagonist, from falling from grace and bringing on his own fate • Form/Structure: Eddie creates a lot of the dramatic tension, and he controls the atmosphere of the play. Act One ends with controlled hostility when Eddie shows Rodolpho how to box. This is mirrored in Act Two when Eddie kisses both Catherine and Rodolpho. Finally, he causes the explosive violence at the end when he seeks out Rodolpho and demands an apology from him for disrespecting him. These flashpoints in the drama raise the tension for the audience who can predict that Eddie's actions will end in tragedy.
--	--

Level	Mark	AO1 Demonstrate a close knowledge and understanding of texts, maintaining a critical style and presenting an informed personal engagement. (15 marks) AO2 Analyse the language, form and structure used by a writer to create meanings and effects. (15 marks)
	0	No rewardable material.
Level 1	1–6	• Limited knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response is simple with little evidence of personal engagement or critical style. • Minimal identification of language, form and structure. • Limited use of relevant examples in support.
Level 2	7–12	• Some knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response may be largely narrative with some evidence of personal engagement or critical style. • Some comment on the language, form and structure. • Some use of relevant examples in support.
Level 3	13–18	• Sound knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response shows relevant personal engagement and an appropriate critical style. • Sound understanding of language, form and structure. • Use of clearly relevant examples in support.
Level 4	19–24	• Thorough knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response shows thorough personal engagement and a sustained critical style. • Sustained analysis of language, form and structure. • Use of fully relevant examples in support.
Level 5	25–30	• Assured knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response shows assured personal engagement and a perceptive critical style. • Cohesive evaluation of language, form and structure. • Discriminating use of relevant examples in support.

Question number	Indicative content
3 An Inspector Calls	Examiners should be alert to a variety of responses and should reward points that are clearly based on evidence from the play. Evidence of a degree of personal response must be given. This is not an exhaustive list but the following points may be made: (AO1) • Mr Arthur Birling and Inspector Goole are the two main characters who control the action but they hold very different views on society: Mr Birling represents capitalist views and Inspector Goole represents socialist views. The contrast between Mr Birling and Inspector Goole serves to highlight the different attitudes to society in the early 20th century • Mr Birling is presented as a wealthy businessman: '<i>a hard-headed, practical man of business</i>'. Inspector Goole enters the Birling household unexpectedly and intrudes on the family celebration giving '<i>the impression of massiveness</i>' and changing the atmosphere in the room. A power struggle between the two then ensues as Mr Birling resents the Inspector's intrusion into the Birling household • Mr Birling is worried about his personal status and reputation in the community, boasting about his role as a magistrate and his hopes for a knighthood. He sees his daughter's marriage like a business deal and hopes it will bring 'lower costs and higher prices' for his business. The Inspector's belief in social equality and community responsibility contrasts with this view as he believes 'We are members of one body' • Mr Birling sees his employees as nothing more than resources that he wants to exploit. They are 'cheap labour' to him. The Inspector values the rights of employees and refers to the many people across the country who have to work for a living. He sees Eva's/Daisy's request for a pay rise as fair, while Mr Birling views it as intolerable insubordination • Mr Birling does not see the need to take responsibility for members of the wider community, even failing to take responsibility for his own son. He is impervious to the Inspector's impassioned 'fire and blood and anguish' speech. The Inspector sees clearly the implications for the human race as a result of the actions of those who do not take responsibility • it becomes obvious to the audience that Inspector Goole is being used as Priestley's mouthpiece to promote his own socialist views and criticise the problems caused by the class divide. In contrast, the character of Mr Birling is shown by Priestley to be foolish and short-sighted when he dismisses the approaching World War as 'silly little war scares'. (AO2) • Language: Mr Birling uses the derisory word 'cranks' to describe people with socialist ideals whereas Inspector Goole refers to 'members of one body' to demonstrate the importance of looking after those beyond one's immediate circle

	• Language: Priestley uses dramatic irony to make Mr Birling look complacent when he talks about the Titanic being 'unsinkable' and dismisses the idea of impending war. The audience know that these things did happen • Language: Inspector Goole uses much more graphic imagery to shock the Birlings: 'Burnt her inside out'. His final speech uses imagery from the Bible: the words 'fire and blood and anguish' sound like the end of the world described in Revelations where people are punished for their sins • Form: Mr Birling is described by Priestley in the opening stage directions as a '<i>heavy-looking, rather portentous man in his middle fifties</i>', stressing Mr Birling's hard and stubborn demeanour. In contrast, Inspector Goole is described in more subtle terms in the stage directions as he enters. He '<i>need not be a big man, but he creates at once an impression of massiveness</i>' • Form: the play takes place in one room, which suggests that the characters have closed themselves off from the world. The lighting is '<i>pink and intimate</i>' at the start as if the Birlings are looking through rose-tinted glasses, but it becomes '<i>brighter</i>' and '<i>harder</i>' when the Inspector arrives, as if he shines a spotlight on their cosy world and exposes their secrets and weaknesses • Structure: the Inspector's approach to questioning the family is direct and takes the form of 'one line of enquiry at a time'. He interviews each one in turn to make the Birlings and Gerald aware of their responsibilities and attempts to activate their consciences.
--	---

Level	Mark	AO1 Demonstrate a close knowledge and understanding of texts, maintaining a critical style and presenting an informed personal engagement. (15 marks) AO2 Analyse the language, form and structure used by a writer to create meanings and effects. (15 marks)
	0	No rewardable material.
Level 1	1–6	• Limited knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response is simple with little evidence of personal engagement or critical style. • Minimal identification of language, form and structure. • Limited use of relevant examples in support.
Level 2	7–12	• Some knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response may be largely narrative with some evidence of personal engagement or critical style. • Some comment on the language, form and structure. • Some use of relevant examples in support.
Level 3	13–18	• Sound knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response shows relevant personal engagement and an appropriate critical style. • Sound understanding of language, form and structure. • Use of clearly relevant examples in support.
Level 4	19–24	• Thorough knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response shows thorough personal engagement and a sustained critical style. • Sustained analysis of language, form and structure. • Use of fully relevant examples in support.
Level 5	25–30	• Assured knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response shows assured personal engagement and a perceptive critical style. • Cohesive evaluation of language, form and structure. • Discriminating use of relevant examples in support.

Question number	Indicative content
4 An Inspector Calls	Examiners should be alert to a variety of responses and should reward points that are clearly based on evidence from the play. Evidence of a degree of personal response must be given. This is not an exhaustive list but the following points may be made: (AO1) • as the play opens, the Birling family appear to be, in Gerald's words, 'a nice, well-behaved family' enjoying the celebration of Sheila's and Gerald's engagement. From the beginning, Priestley provides clues for the audience that the family are not being honest with each other. He uses the character of Inspector Goole to show that honesty is important in families and society • as the play progresses, the Inspector exposes their secrets such as Eric's drinking, Gerald's affair and the way each of them plays a part in Eva Smith's/Daisy Renton's demise • even in Mr Birling's speech at the party there are hints of subterfuge under the surface. He says that 'this is one of the happiest days of my life' but it is not solely because he wants to see his daughter happily married. He sees the Crofts as more established and socially superior than him and the marriage will be a beneficial business move with the merger of both companies • during the Inspector's questioning, Mr Birling admits that he sacked Eva/Daisy from her job at his factory for her part as a ringleader in the strike for better pay. He wanted to protect his business profits • Sheila seems to be honest about her role in Eva's/Daisy's demise and reveals under the Inspector's scrutiny about how she got the girl sacked: 'I went straight to the manager and told him the girl was very impertinent'. She does not reveal the important truth that it was her own insecurity and jealousy that led to her over reaction until the Inspector forces her to • Gerald tries initially to conceal his involvement with Eva/Daisy from Sheila and the others, although Eric may suspect something. Gerald suggests that Sheila would be better off out of the room while the Inspector questions him, but she chooses to stay. The revelation of his affair leads to Sheila's calling off the engagement. However, Gerald is still prepared to go back to his old ways of covering up the truth once he thinks the Inspector is not real as he does not see the importance of truth • Mrs Birling tries to pretend that her family are respectable, although the opposite is staring her in the face. She will not believe that Eric drinks, that Gerald has had an affair or that a girl of Eva's/Daisy's class could be honest enough to refuse money: 'She was giving herself ridiculous airs' • from the start of the play, Eric shows that he is not saying what he really thinks or wants. He is described as '<i>not quite at ease</i>' and later clashes with his parents, criticising them for pretending that nothing has happened. He has kept secrets: the extent of his drinking, that he made Eva/Daisy pregnant and that he stole from the firm. It is important that, at the end of the play, he is finally able to say what he means and be honest about the way he views the failings of the family. (AO2)

	• Language: the Birlings use euphemisms to hide what they mean. This is their way of being vague and avoiding the truth. Mr Birling talks about 'the girl's condition' rather than mentioning pregnancy. Mrs Birling says Eva/Daisy is 'a girl of that sort' rather than calling her a prostitute. Gerald talks about 'women of the town' • Language: Priestley's subtle language hints at the lack of honesty that lies below the surface of the Birling family's lives. An example is when Sheila refers to the time 'last summer' when Gerald 'never came near' her, showing that they do not share the truth • Language/Structure: the younger generation realise the folly of not saying what they really mean once the Inspector has made them face up to their shortcomings, but the older generation and Gerald are happy to resume their old lives and cover up the truth. This causes conflict within the family once the Inspector has left and Sheila says 'You're just beginning to pretend all over again'. Gerald's reaction is very different when he says 'Everything's all right now, Sheila' • Form/Structure: the play's dramatic ending relies on the initial subterfuge of Inspector Goole who does not reveal his true identity or his real reason for being there. He says he is an inspector and tells the Birlings and Gerald that a young girl has already died in the Infirmary. At the end of the play, when Mr Birling takes the phone call, the shock dénouement reveals that the death has only just occurred and that an inspector is on his way • Form/Structure: the play's structure shows the gradual exposure of secrets, about which the Inspector forces them to be honest. It follows some conventions of the murder mystery genre where the truth is revealed.
--	--

Level	Mark	AO1 Demonstrate a close knowledge and understanding of texts, maintaining a critical style and presenting an informed personal engagement. (15 marks) AO2 Analyse the language, form and structure used by a writer to create meanings and effects. (15 marks)
	0	No rewardable material.
Level 1	1–6	• Limited knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response is simple with little evidence of personal engagement or critical style. • Minimal identification of language, form and structure. • Limited use of relevant examples in support.
Level 2	7–12	• Some knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response may be largely narrative with some evidence of personal engagement or critical style. • Some comment on the language, form and structure. • Some use of relevant examples in support.
Level 3	13–18	• Sound knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response shows relevant personal engagement and an appropriate critical style. • Sound understanding of language, form and structure. • Use of clearly relevant examples in support.
Level 4	19–24	• Thorough knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response shows thorough personal engagement and a sustained critical style. • Sustained analysis of language, form and structure. • Use of fully relevant examples in support.
Level 5	25–30	• Assured knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response shows assured personal engagement and a perceptive critical style. • Cohesive evaluation of language, form and structure. • Discriminating use of relevant examples in support.

Question number	Indicative content
5 <i>The Curious Incident of the Dog in the Night-time</i>	Examiners should be alert to a variety of responses and should reward points that are clearly based on evidence from the play. Evidence of a degree of personal response must be given. This is not an exhaustive list but the following points may be made: (AO1) • Christopher's book is his private diary where he writes his secret thoughts about Wellington's murder. It is more like a detective's notebook in which he builds up the facts about his investigation. It is important as it the method by which Christopher's inner thoughts and feelings are conveyed to the audience • nobody else reads the book except him and his teacher, Siobhan. From the beginning of the play, Siobhan reads from the book like a narrator, sharing Christopher's findings with the audience: 'It was seven minutes after midnight. The dog was lying on the grass in the middle of the lawn in front of Mrs Shears' house'. She does this because Christopher finds it difficult to talk to people he does not know and would not speak directly to the audience at this stage of the play • one important dramatic climax in the play is when his father, Ed, finds out about the book and Siobhan feels she must hand it over to him. When his father reads what Christopher has written about, he forbids him to carry on with the investigation: 'Promise me that you will give up this ridiculous game right now, OK?' Christopher sees this as the end of the book as well as the investigation. He tells Siobhan 'So the book is finished' • his father's anger on the discovery of the book leads to a physical fight between him and Christopher: '<i>Ed shakes Christopher hard with both hands. Christopher punches Ed repeatedly in the face. He cuts his mouth. Ed hits the side of Christopher's head. Christopher falls unconscious for a few seconds</i>'. This is an important turning point in their relationship as his father knows that Christopher cannot cope with physical contact of any sort • he is disappointed that his book is not going to be finished: 'It's not a proper book', 'It doesn't have a proper ending. I never found out who killed Wellington'. Siobhan tells him that he should still be proud of what he has written • the most important dramatic climax of the play is caused by Christopher's desire to find where his father has hidden his book. He sees this as another detective investigation: 'I detected in the kitchen', 'I detected in the bathroom'. This leads to his finding the letters from his mother in his father's shirt box alongside his book, and to his leaving home to find his mother • the book is an important link between Christopher's two investigations: the murder of Wellington and his mother's disappearance: 'When I started writing my book there was only one mystery to solve. Now there were two'

- at the end of Part One, after another physical fight with his father over his hiding his mother's letters, Christopher decides to go to London and try to find his mother. In Part Two, Christopher must be more independent and speak for himself. When Siobhan asks him if his book could be made into a school play, he refuses, saying 'No. It's a book and it's for me and not everybody, just for me'.

(AO2)

- Language: the factual language of Christopher's book reflects his logical mind and attention to detail: 'I went up to my bedroom and turned on my bedroom light and played six games of Tetris and got to level 38 which is my fourth best ever score'. His language is always concrete because he does not understand or trust abstract thoughts
- Language: the structure of his sentences reflect his innocent, child-like view of the world: his use of a lot of compound sentences with co-ordinating conjunctions shows the flow of his thoughts as he struggles to make sense of what he sees: 'Sometimes when I want to be on my own I get into the airing cupboard and slide in there beside the boiler and pull the door closed behind me and sit there and think for hours and it makes me feel very calm'
- Form/Structure: Christopher's book is used by Siobhan as the main script for the play in Part One when she reads it aloud to the audience. In Part Two, Christopher no longer needs Siobhan to speak for him as he must try to interact with an unknown world alone
- Structure: Christopher's book is used as a dramatic device for the audience, Siobhan and, ultimately, his father, to eavesdrop on his thoughts. When his father reads the book, we know that something awful is going to happen and that we are about to watch two people badly hurting each other.

Level	Mark	AO1 Demonstrate a close knowledge and understanding of texts, maintaining a critical style and presenting an informed personal engagement. (15 marks) AO2 Analyse the language, form and structure used by a writer to create meanings and effects. (15 marks)
	0	No rewardable material.
Level 1	1–6	• Limited knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response is simple with little evidence of personal engagement or critical style. • Minimal identification of language, form and structure. • Limited use of relevant examples in support.
Level 2	7–12	• Some knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response may be largely narrative with some evidence of personal engagement or critical style. • Some comment on the language, form and structure. • Some use of relevant examples in support.
Level 3	13–18	• Sound knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response shows relevant personal engagement and an appropriate critical style. • Sound understanding of language, form and structure. • Use of clearly relevant examples in support.
Level 4	19–24	• Thorough knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response shows thorough personal engagement and a sustained critical style. • Sustained analysis of language, form and structure. • Use of fully relevant examples in support.
Level 5	25–30	• Assured knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response shows assured personal engagement and a perceptive critical style. • Cohesive evaluation of language, form and structure. • Discriminating use of relevant examples in support.

Question number	Indicative content
6 <i>The Curious Incident of the Dog in the Night-time</i>	Examiners should be alert to a variety of responses and should reward points that are clearly based on evidence from the play. Evidence of a degree of personal response must be given. This is not an exhaustive list but the following points may be made: (AO1) • many of the characters face challenges in the play. Candidates are likely to choose Christopher, Ed, Judy or Siobhan, but any choice is valid. Responses should be assessed on the ideas presented • Christopher faces the challenge of living with autism, which results in his seeing things differently from the other characters. Christopher's main challenge involves his gaining the self-confidence needed to do things on his own and moving beyond his very rigidly defined comfort zone • Christopher also faces the challenge of coping with the marital breakup of his mother and father although, at first, he thinks his mother has passed away. He tells Mrs Alexander 'she had a heart attack when she was in hospital', as this is what he has been led to believe by his father • on finding out that his father has been lying to him, when, in fact, his mother is living in London and has written him letters that he has never received, Christopher has a physical seizure: <i>'He rolls himself into a ball. He starts hitting his hands and his feet and his head against the floor as the letter continues'</i>, <i>'He has been sick'</i>. He must first cope with the discovery that his father was responsible both for these lies and the death of Wellington. He then must cope with the journey to London on his own to find his mother • Christopher's father, Ed, does not cope well with the challenge of his wife's affair with Mr Shears and her subsequent leaving of him. His anger leads to his lying to Christopher: 'Christopher, I'm sorry, your mother's died'. He hides her letters to Christopher and kills Wellington in a jealous rage after a row with Mrs Shears, with whom he has become very friendly. He tells Christopher 'Life is difficult, you know. It's bloody hard telling the truth all the time'. At the end, he copes with mending his relationship with Christopher, including giving him a puppy • Christopher's mother, Judy, must cope with having an autistic son, which she finds very difficult. She then has to cope with her affair with Mr Shears and the decision to leave Ed and Christopher for a new life in London. Her letters to Christopher reveal that she regrets having to leave him: 'I hope you don't stay angry with me forever'. Once she is reunited with Christopher at the end of the play, she moves with him to a flat in Swindon, leaving Mr Shears • Siobhan, Christopher's teacher, copes well with Christopher, and is his main support throughout the play. She hands his book to his father out of duty, which causes great conflict between Christopher and his father, and afterwards she is concerned about his safety: 'Christopher are you frightened of going home?' When Christopher leaves for London to find his mother, she does not accompany him, although her guiding words are often in his head. Indeed, after Christopher's return from London, when he asks if he can come and live with her, she refuses him saying 'because I am not your mother'

- Mrs Alexander, Christopher's neighbour, has to cope with Christopher's questioning about Wellington's death and his mother. She deals with this difficult situation in a sensitive way, revealing to him that his mother was having an affair with Mr Shears: 'I am going to say something to you and you must promise not to tell your father that I told you this'. This later causes conflict with his father when he reads about it in Christopher's book.

(AO2)

- Language: Christopher's language is factual and logical. He does not understand metaphor and implied meaning: 'It just confuses me because imagining an apple in someone's eye doesn't have anything to do with liking someone a lot'. It is a challenge to him to work out the real meaning of what he is told
- Language: Siobhan tries to help Christopher overcome the challenge to understand what other people mean by breaking down ideas into language he can relate to: 'But people like stories, Christopher. Some people find things which are kind of true in things which are made up'
- Language: his father uses euphemism when he lies about Christopher's mother's death: 'She has a problem ... A problem with her heart'. Christopher takes this to mean that she has had a heart attack
- Form/Structure: when Christopher travels to London by himself, the stage directions show how he is now able to overcome his fear of talking to strangers: '*He approaches an information counter*'. He is better at coping with people and challenging situations that are unfamiliar to him
- Form/Structure: the play can be considered a bildungsroman as Christopher comes of age during its action and he learns a lot about the world. The play ends with Christopher acknowledging what he has achieved. He is proud of the way he has coped with his challenges: 'Does that mean I can do anything?'

Level	Mark	AO1 Demonstrate a close knowledge and understanding of texts, maintaining a critical style and presenting an informed personal engagement. (15 marks) AO2 Analyse the language, form and structure used by a writer to create meanings and effects. (15 marks)
	0	No rewardable material.
Level 1	1–6	• Limited knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response is simple with little evidence of personal engagement or critical style. • Minimal identification of language, form and structure. • Limited use of relevant examples in support.
Level 2	7–12	• Some knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response may be largely narrative with some evidence of personal engagement or critical style. • Some comment on the language, form and structure. • Some use of relevant examples in support.
Level 3	13–18	• Sound knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response shows relevant personal engagement and an appropriate critical style. • Sound understanding of language, form and structure. • Use of clearly relevant examples in support.
Level 4	19–24	• Thorough knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response shows thorough personal engagement and a sustained critical style. • Sustained analysis of language, form and structure. • Use of fully relevant examples in support.
Level 5	25–30	• Assured knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response shows assured personal engagement and a perceptive critical style. • Cohesive evaluation of language, form and structure. • Discriminating use of relevant examples in support.

Question number	Indicative content
7 Kinder-transport	Examiners should be alert to a variety of responses and should reward points that are clearly based on evidence from the play. Evidence of a degree of personal response must be given. This is not an exhaustive list but the following points may be made: (AO1) • there are several difficult decisions that have to be made in the play, including Eva's/Evelyn's refusal to accompany her mother, Helga, to America. Candidates are likely to refer to any of the following but may also include their own ideas • as Eva gets older, she realises that to fit in with her new culture she must make the difficult decision to change her identity. She changes her name to Evelyn and becomes a Christian. She blames Judaism for all her problems. She tells Faith 'I was baptized when I was eighteen. I was cleansed that day. Purified' • however, she suffers from enormous guilt over these decisions, which becomes destructive. Her guilt is over how she survived, how she treated her birth mother and her rejection of her Jewish faith. Eva/Evelyn spends her life reflecting on how her life might have been. She says to Helga 'Didn't it ever occur to you that I might have wanted to die with you?' • when Helga first comes to England and meets Eva/Evelyn, she accepts that her daughter's name was changed as a necessity for her to survive in England. The importance of the name change to Eva/Evelyn is not fully understood by Helga: 'We have all done bad things in the last years that we regret. That is how we survive'. Later, Helga acknowledges how her daughter has completely changed her identity: 'I am looking for my daughter Eva, if you find her, Evelyn' • Helga is Eva's/Evelyn's mother, but she must make the very difficult decision to send her daughter, Eva, away from her homeland to England on the Kindertransport. Helga sees it as her duty to protect her daughter by ensuring that she is safe from the treatment of Jewish people in Germany at the time: 'Because any good parent would want to protect their child' • this decision leads to her losing her daughter twice during the play: once when Eva leaves on the Kindertransport and the second time after the war, when Helga comes to England to take Eva/Evelyn with her to America, but her daughter refuses to go with her. The first time she feels guilty about sending Eva away, but she also feels justified, as she knows she will be saving Eva's life. The second time she feels very hurt and rejected and questions her decision to send her to England. Helga has survived Auschwitz by thinking of her daughter and imagining them both together in happier times • Lil has made the difficult decision to not tell Faith about her mother's past. She is a person who wants to help and do good. She has kept Evelyn's secret because Evelyn has gone through so much it seemed safer and kinder to do what Evelyn wanted. She only ever lied to protect Evelyn. But once the great big secret is out, Lil can stop protecting Evelyn so much and help Faith grow up

- Faith must make the difficult decision to go against her mother's wishes and find out about her relatives. She also wants an explanation as to why her mother is as she is. As an only child, finding an extended family would mean a lot to Faith as she would feel less isolated: 'I'm going to find out what everything means'.

(AO2)

- Language: Eva's change of name to Evelyn represents how she wants to forget her past and change her identity, which was a difficult decision for her
- Form: when Eva realises that her parents are not coming to England, the stage directions show how she removes her rings and Star of David. Eva/Evelyn is only able to survive by shutting out her past: 'I don't want these on me any more'
- Form/Structure: throughout the play Evelyn cleans to clear her guilty conscience. The stage directions metaphorically emphasise Evelyn's way of surviving her difficult decision: '*Evelyn continues to polish*'
- Form/Structure: jumping between three time periods supports the idea that all generations have been affected by past difficult decisions. This is clarified by the consistent setting as all the action on stage takes place in the attic of Evelyn's home, though other settings in her life are suggested using sound, for example of the train and the ship
- Structure: Helga tells Eva that she will need to be able to cope on her own. Eventually, Eva/Evelyn has been affected by experiences so much that she no longer needs Helga, and she rejects her. The structure of the play, switching between childhood and adulthood, highlights the effect of the difficult decisions to separate.

Level	Mark	AO1 Demonstrate a close knowledge and understanding of texts, maintaining a critical style and presenting an informed personal engagement. (15 marks) AO2 Analyse the language, form and structure used by a writer to create meanings and effects. (15 marks)
	0	No rewardable material.
Level 1	1–6	• Limited knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response is simple with little evidence of personal engagement or critical style. • Minimal identification of language, form and structure. • Limited use of relevant examples in support.
Level 2	7–12	• Some knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response may be largely narrative with some evidence of personal engagement or critical style. • Some comment on the language, form and structure. • Some use of relevant examples in support
Level 3	13–18	• Sound knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response shows relevant personal engagement and an appropriate critical style. • Sound understanding of language, form and structure. • Use of clearly relevant examples in support.
Level 4	19–24	• Thorough knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response shows thorough personal engagement and a sustained critical style. • Sustained analysis of language, form and structure. • Use of fully relevant examples in support.
Level 5	25–30	• Assured knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response shows assured personal engagement and a perceptive critical style. • Cohesive evaluation of language, form and structure. • Discriminating use of relevant examples in support.

Question number	Indicative content
8 Kinder-transport	Examiners should be alert to a variety of responses and should reward points that are clearly based on evidence from the play. Evidence of a degree of personal response must be given. This is not an exhaustive list but the following points may be made: (AO1) • the role of the Ratcatcher is very important because he is always present in the play in one form or another, and adds to a lot of the dramatic tension • the Ratcatcher is a mythical character from a children's storybook, <i>Der Rattenfänger</i>. He is malevolent and sinister, haunting Eva/Evelyn throughout the play. He is the one we know as the Pied Piper of Hamelin, who tempts children to follow him before subjecting them to great cruelty. He is described as: '<i>the shadow growing legs</i>', '<i>and strong arms and spiky nails</i>', '<i>And eyes sharp as razors</i>' • he represents what the other characters are repressing: he physically changes depending on what he is expressing at that precise moment • he is everything Eva/Evelyn tries to run away from and everything she fears. The more she tries to suppress her feelings, the stronger the Ratcatcher becomes. Evelyn decides to lie about her past and she is haunted by the Ratcatcher even after she and Lil have tried to destroy the book: '<i>It's in German. Horrible pictures</i>' • the Ratcatcher is a constant reminder of the past catching up with the characters. He also plays the part of the Nazi Border Official, the English Organiser, the Postman and the Station Guard, which means that he is present at each stage of Eva's escape from Germany as if he is pursuing her • the Ratcatcher is present at the opening of the play when Eva and her mother, Helga, are packing for her to leave for England. Eva is reading the children's story book, <i>Der Rattenfänger</i>, which is her favourite bedtime story • the next time the book is opened is when Faith pulls it out of a box in the attic where she and her mother are packing for her to leave. Immediately, the pipe music is heard, which signals the presence of the Ratcatcher and transports the scene back to Helga and Eva packing again. Her mother immediately tells her '<i>Not that one</i>', '<i>Choose something else</i>', as if she does not want Eva to take the Ratcatcher with her • however, in various guises, he does manage to follow Eva/Evelyn and appears again after her row with Faith when Faith starts to find out about the past. Evelyn talks to her younger self to reassure her that she will protect her against the Ratcatcher: '<i>I won't let him. I'll do everything I can to stop him</i>' • his last appearance is at the end of the play when Faith and Evelyn leave the attic, seemingly mocking Evelyn's last line: '<i>All done in here then</i>', proving that she will never be free of her fear of the past.

(AO2)

- Language: the menacing figure of the Ratcatcher uses threatening language, which brings fear to the young Eva: 'I will take the heart of your happiness away'
- Language: as the Postman, he is presented as an embodiment of racism. When he enters '*He is frog-marching, making a Hitler moustache on his upper lip with the index finger of one hand and doing the Nazi salute with the other*'. This is reminding Eva of the Germany she left behind
- Form: the play is set in an attic, which represents a place where secrets are stored and hidden. Here amongst the memories, the Ratcatcher is omnipresent: he creeps, dark and hidden away, through walls or out of suitcases. When Faith opens the book, he is released like a genie out of a bottle
- Structure: the Ratcatcher is used as a dramatic device to create tension and add suspense. His music is heard at different times throughout the play to remind the audience that past secrets and fears are ever present. He is there in the parallel packing scene between Eva and Faith when they share lines in reading his description from the book
- Structure: as Faith leaves the stage at the end of the play, the stage directions tell us '*the shadow of the Ratcatcher covers the stage*'. The play ends as it began with the Ratcatcher as a central figure dominating the stage.

Level	Mark	AO1 Demonstrate a close knowledge and understanding of texts, maintaining a critical style and presenting an informed personal engagement. (15 marks) AO2 Analyse the language, form and structure used by a writer to create meanings and effects. (15 marks)
	0	No rewardable material.
Level 1	1–6	• Limited knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response is simple with little evidence of personal engagement or critical style. • Minimal identification of language, form and structure. • Limited use of relevant examples in support.
Level 2	7–12	• Some knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response may be largely narrative with some evidence of personal engagement or critical style. • Some comment on the language, form and structure. • Some use of relevant examples in support.
Level 3	13–18	• Sound knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response shows relevant personal engagement and an appropriate critical style. • Sound understanding of language, form and structure. • Use of clearly relevant examples in support.
Level 4	19–24	• Thorough knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response shows thorough personal engagement and a sustained critical style. • Sustained analysis of language, form and structure. • Use of fully relevant examples in support.
Level 5	25–30	• Assured knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response shows assured personal engagement and a perceptive critical style. • Cohesive evaluation of language, form and structure. • Discriminating use of relevant examples in support.

Question number	Indicative content
9 <i>Death and the King's Horseman</i>	Examiners should be alert to a variety of responses and should reward points that are clearly based on evidence from the play. Evidence of a degree of personal response must be given. This is not an exhaustive list but the following points may be made: (AO1) • candidates are free to agree or disagree, wholly or in part, with the view that Elesin deserves forgiveness when he says at the end of the play 'May the world forgive me'. Responses should be assessed based on the arguments presented • Elesin asks for forgiveness at the end of the play because he does not carry out his duty and has brought shame on his people and their traditions. Elesin is the King's Horseman, and Yoruba tradition dictates that he must fulfil the death ritual to accompany the King into the afterlife • it could be argued that Elesin does not take his role as the King's Horseman seriously enough. Soyinka illustrates the strong connection Elesin feels to his life among the living by showing his desire for material and physical pleasure. The women in the market who Elesin flirts with dress him in beautiful clothing, much to his delight. He also takes a beautiful young bride for his own pleasure • Iyaloja cautions that this may tie him more closely to the living world as he is supposed to be approaching death, but Elesin refuses to heed the warning. She tells him 'It takes an Elesin to die the death of death', 'gracefully does the horseman regain / The stables at the end of day, gracefully' • Elesin is indeed unable to fulfil his duty to the people of Yoruba and the King by ending his own life. Instead of seeking forgiveness for this, at first he shifts the blame onto his new bride, asserting that he has been unable to resist her. However, ultimately, he admits he has not ended his life because he loves it too much • the play argues that Elesin fails to end his life in the manner tradition demands. Through the words of the other characters, it is deemed that death is both inevitable and honourable, especially when one has the opportunity to prepare for it. Therefore, his people believe Elesin has been wrong to refuse it and has acted dishonourably: 'They have slain the favourite horse of the king and slain his dog', 'But the rider has chosen to stay behind' • candidates might share the view of Jane Pilkings who, as a Christian, believes that life is something that must be preserved at all costs and thus finds the idea of taking one's own life unforgivable. She cannot see the value in this tradition, even though it would allow Elesin control over the time and way he dies • Simon Pilkings attempts to stop Elesin's death ritual, which is set to occur during a visit by a Prince from England. He even points out a Yoruba proverb that states that no one ever is fully willing to die and suggests that his hesitation to die is normal, even in Elesin's culture: 'Are these not the same people who say the elder grimly approaches heaven?' This suggests Elesin's reluctance is forgivable even to those who share the same belief system. However, he prevents Elesin from carrying out the ritual for selfish reasons as he does not want the Prince to see any unrest

- Iyaloja implies that the ultimate transgression is that Elesin and Pilkings cannot accept death, as each person must be allowed to greet it in their own way. Iyaloja blames Pilkings for Elesin's dishonour and death, saying he 'usurp[s] the vestments of our dead, yet believe[s] that the stain of death will not cling' to him.

(AO2)

- Language: Jane shows no understanding of the ritual, calling it 'murder'. She uses an emphatically placed adverb to show how much she values life and believes it should be protected as far as possible: 'Life should never be thrown deliberately away'. She does not believe Elesin needs forgiveness
- Language: as the King's Horseman, Elesin fails to complete his prime function, the death ritual. The villagers believe that all that lies before him is shame and misery in the afterlife. Iyaloja, their spokeswoman, describes his fate in bleak terms: 'The passage is clogged with droppings from the King's stallion; he will arrive all stained in dung'
- Language/Structure: the use of 'and' to separate *Death and the King's Horseman* in the title is significant as it divides Elesin from the state of death that he has a duty to reach but cannot perform the ritual required of him
- Form/Structure: the Praise-Singer's function in the play is to engage in discussion with Elesin and find out about his intentions and mindset in relation to the ritual. He acts as a link between the worlds of the living and the dead and reminds Elesin of his duty: 'Are the drums on the other side now tuning skin to skin with ours in Osugbo?'
- Structure: when Elesin takes his own life in his cell at the end of the play, this is ironic as he has no honour left but dies anyway. The lack of forgiveness for his not doing his duty provides the play's tragic dénouement
- Structure: at the end of the play, Jane still believes that locking Elesin up to prevent him from fulfilling the ritual has been the right thing to do. Olunde's lack of forgiveness for his father and his dedication to the ritual, in order to restore the family honour, results in his own death as well as his father's.

Level	Mark	AO1 Demonstrate a close knowledge and understanding of texts, maintaining a critical style and presenting an informed personal engagement. (15 marks) AO2 Analyse the language, form and structure used by a writer to create meanings and effects. (15 marks)
	0	No rewardable material.
Level 1	1–6	• Limited knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response is simple with little evidence of personal engagement or critical style. • Minimal identification of language, form and structure. • Limited use of relevant examples in support.
Level 2	7–12	• Some knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response may be largely narrative with some evidence of personal engagement or critical style. • Some use of relevant examples in support.
Level 3	13–18	• Sound knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response shows relevant personal engagement and an appropriate critical style. • Sound understanding of language, form and structure. • Use of clearly relevant examples in support.
Level 4	19–24	• Thorough knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response shows thorough personal engagement and a sustained critical style. • Sustained analysis of language, form and structure. • Use of fully relevant examples in support.
Level 5	25–30	• Assured knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response shows assured personal engagement and a perceptive critical style. • Cohesive evaluation of language, form and structure. • Discriminating use of relevant examples in support.

Question number	Indicative content
10 <i>Death and the King's Horseman</i>	Examiners should be alert to a variety of responses and should reward points that are clearly based on evidence from the play. Evidence of a degree of personal response must be given. This is not an exhaustive list but the following points may be made: (AO1) • the Yoruba culture is steeped in tradition, and the idea of honour, both personal and communal, is significant to the events of the play • in the opening scene of the play, the Praise-Singer cautions that the world must stay on a traditional course or there will be no more world. The Praise-Singer calls Elesin an honourable man for accepting his role fully • Elesin's significant role is to fulfil his duty as the King's Horseman to maintain the Yoruba's spiritual wellness and order. At first, he is shown as honourable as the women tell him 'We know you for a man of honour', and his son, Olunde, has no doubt that his father will carry out his duty: 'I know he is dead' • however, Elesin fails at his duty as the King's Horseman and dishonours himself in both the living world and the afterlife by not committing the ritualistic death taking. Eventually, his lack of action results in the loss of his own son, who takes his place as the King's Horseman to restore order and honour • at the end of the play, faced with the catastrophe his actions have caused, Elesin does take his own life but it is not enough to set things right or return his honour. Iyaloja tells him, after the death of Olunde, 'There lies the honour of your household and of our race. Because he could not bear to let honour fly out of doors, he has topped it with his life' • Simon Pilkings shows no honour in his role as District Officer and does not appreciate the significance of the Yoruba tradition and the local belief system, although his true aim in this is to maintain order. Pilkings' attempts to fulfil his duty to keep the colony under control are not always successful. He is only concerned with the local people when there is someone he is trying to impress • ultimately, it is significant that Olunde is the only male character to show honour and dutifulness as he takes his father's place to maintain spiritual order for his people. He believes that the death of one for many is a great and worthy sacrifice. He tells Jane Pilkings, when her husband tries to stop the ritual death ceremony, 'What can you offer him in place of his peace of mind, in place of the honour and veneration of his own people?' • in his discussion with Jane, Olunde shows how he respects this type of honourable sacrifice when he disagrees with her about the story she shares of a Captain dying aboard his ship to protect others on land • though Olunde's act is honourable in the eyes of the Yoruba people, it does bring about other moral issues. This act by Olunde dishonours Elesin, his father, who has not followed tradition. Also, Olunde will no longer be able to serve as a doctor, and his role as a Horseman to the next King will not be able to be fulfilled. In this way, the Yoruba people will possibly have the dilemma of not being able to uphold their honourable tradition.

(AO2)

- Language: Iyaloja blames Pilkings for Elesin's dishonour, using metaphorical language to show how their customs have been violated: he 'usurp[s] the vestments of our dead, yet believe[s] that the stain of death will not cling'
- Language: much of the language is symbolic of Yoruba tradition, which is linked closely to nature and cycles of life. When Elesin is wavering in his duty, Iyaloja scolds him: 'The swallow is never seen to peck holes in its nest when it is time to move with the season', reminding him of the importance of honourable sacrifice
- Language/Form: throughout the play, the power of words and speech is shown to be as significant as that of action, which is exercised by the men. Elesin loses his honour and, therefore, his identity. He tells Pilkings 'Give me back the name you have taken away from me you ghost from the land of the nameless!'
- Form: much of the play's action is centred on music, ritualistic chanting and drumming, which are significant to the Yoruba tradition. The drumming changes in intensity to build up tension and herald Elesin's death. Elesin explains that the moon is the guide that shows when the door to the next world appears. However, humans cannot see this gateway, and that is why the drums are used. The drums were to signal when Elesin was to depart earth
- Structure: the ending of the play is unexpected and does not resolve issues raised in the play. Both Elesin and Pilkings fail in their duty to act for the collective good by proving to be selfish in their actions. Olunde is the only male character who remains honourable and dutiful. However, his sacrifice could lead to the end of the Yoruba Horseman tradition as there is now no one to take on the role, unless Iyaloja's hint of an unborn child comes to fruition.

Level	Mark	AO1 Demonstrate a close knowledge and understanding of texts, maintaining a critical style and presenting an informed personal engagement. (15 marks) AO2 Analyse the language, form and structure used by a writer to create meanings and effects. (15 marks)
	0	No rewardable material.
Level 1	1–6	• Limited knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response is simple with little evidence of personal engagement or critical style. • Minimal identification of language, form and structure. • Limited use of relevant examples in support.
Level 2	7–12	• Some knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response may be largely narrative with some evidence of personal engagement or critical style. • Some comment on the language, form and structure. • Some use of relevant examples in support.
Level 3	13–18	• Sound knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response shows relevant personal engagement and an appropriate critical style. • Sound understanding of language, form and structure. • Use of clearly relevant examples in support.
Level 4	19–24	• Thorough knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response shows thorough personal engagement and a sustained critical style. • Sustained analysis of language, form and structure. • Use of fully relevant examples in support.
Level 5	25–30	• Assured knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response shows assured personal engagement and a perceptive critical style. • Cohesive evaluation of language, form and structure. • Discriminating use of relevant examples in support.

SECTION B – Literary Heritage Texts

Question number	Indicative content
11 <i>Romeo and Juliet</i>	Examiners should be alert to a variety of responses and should reward points that are clearly based on evidence from the play. Evidence of a degree of personal response must be given. This is not an exhaustive list but the following points may be made: (AO1) • at the point in the play when Juliet says ‘Madam, I am here. What is your will?’ she has not yet met Romeo. Her mother has summoned her to ask her about her desire to be married to Paris, who has shown an interest in being her suitor. Juliet is only 13 years old and tells her mother ‘It is an honour that I dream not of’. The fact that she calls her mother ‘Madam’ shows the formality of their relationship • furthermore, Lady Capulet asks the Nurse to be present, suggesting a lack of closeness, when she urges Juliet to start contemplating marriage. Lady Capulet then mentions that she gave birth to Juliet at an age not much older than Juliet's, and views it as Juliet's duty to marry a man of wealth regardless of age: ‘Here in Verona, ladies of esteem, / Are made already mothers’. This shows that she did not marry for love, and she expects her daughter to do the same • Lady Capulet is unaware of Juliet's true emotions, and later in the play when Juliet refuses to marry Paris, she tries to ignore her wishes and insists Juliet put on a positive front, accept her destiny and go along with her parents' plans for her. Her experience of an arranged marriage at a young age is affecting the way she treats Juliet in their relationship • Juliet confides in the Nurse, not her mother, about her marriage to Romeo and Lady Capulet believes that her grief, later in the play when Romeo is banished, is because of her cousin Tybalt's death. She is severe with her then and tells her she must show more strength: ‘Some grief shows much of love, / But much of grief shows still some want of wit’ • when Lord Capulet is threatening violence against his daughter, her mother does not stand up for her, even when he threatens to disown her if she refuses to marry Paris. She tells her husband ‘I would the fool were married to her grave’ • Lady Capulet refuses to discuss the marriage to Paris after Juliet disobeys her father, which shows that she has no interest in her daughter's feelings or happiness: ‘Talk not to me, for I'll not speak a word. / Do as thou wilt, for I have done with thee’. This is the final breakdown in their relationship, and from then on Juliet misleads her into thinking she will agree to marry Paris • the Nurse's relationship with Juliet is very different from that with her mother. She is treated like a friend, yet, ultimately, she is a servant. She has been caring for Juliet since she was born and even nursed her. She acts more like a mother to her and knows more about her as she grows up • at the end of the play, when Lady Capulet sees her daughter's body, she feels the weight of guilt for what has happened and looks towards her own death: ‘O me, this sight of death is as a bell / That warns my old age to a sepulchre’.

(AO2)

- Language: Juliet addresses her mother very formally as 'lady mother', which shows the distance between them in their relationship
- Language: Juliet's mother speaks to her with a lot of commands: 'Here comes your father, tell him so yourself'. Her tone towards Juliet is often very cold and unsympathetic
- Form: dramatic irony is created when Juliet's mother thinks she is crying over Tybalt's death and she is really crying because of Romeo's banishment: 'Well, girl, thou weep'st not so much for his death / As that the villain lives which slaughtered him'. The audience knows that Juliet would not want Romeo killed
- Form: the tragedy illustrates the consequences of parents not hearing and respecting their children. The parents have let the 'ancient grudge' go on without resolving it, and it is only the death of their children that reunites them
- Structure: Lady Capulet is angry with Juliet for disobeying her father, who tells Juliet that he will disown her if she refuses to marry Paris. She believes Juliet is being disloyal to her parents' wishes. This ultimately leads to Friar Lawrence's fateful plan
- Structure: the death of her daughter makes Lady Capulet rethink her priorities at the end of the play.

(AO4)

- the play is set at a time when society was patriarchal, but Juliet shows her strong individual character in standing up against her parents' wish for her to marry Paris. This disobedience might have shocked a contemporary audience
- Shakespeare demonstrates the Capulets' and Montagues' attitude to their children by showing their focus on social and political advancement. It was common in the 16th and 17th centuries for parents to arrange socially advantageous marriages, even if their children were unhappy
- many of Shakespeare's works explore the obligations of children and younger generations to their parents or elders
- wealthy parents often let servants take responsibility for the upbringing of their children. Shakespeare himself had children who he left behind when he left Stratford for London.

Level	Mark	AO1 Demonstrate a close knowledge and understanding of texts, maintaining a critical style and presenting an informed personal engagement. (10 marks) AO2 Analyse the language, form and structure used by a writer to create meanings and effects. (10 marks) AO4 Show understanding of the relationships between texts and the contexts in which they were written. (10 marks)
	0	No rewardable material.
Level 1	1–6	• Limited knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response is simple with little evidence of personal engagement or critical style. • Minimal identification of language, form and structure. • There is little comment on the relationship between text and context. • Limited use of relevant examples in support.
Level 2	7–12	• Some knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response may be largely narrative with some evidence of personal engagement or critical style. • Some comment on the language, form and structure. • There is some comment on the relationship between text and context. • Some use of relevant examples in support.
Level 3	13–18	• Sound knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response shows relevant personal engagement and an appropriate critical style. • Sound understanding of language, form and structure. • There is relevant comment on the relationship between text and context. • Use of clearly relevant examples in support.
Level 4	19–24	• Thorough knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response shows thorough personal engagement and a sustained critical style. • Sustained analysis of language, form and structure. • There is a detailed awareness of the relationship between text and context. • Use of fully relevant examples in support.
Level 5	25–30	• Assured knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response shows assured personal engagement and a perceptive critical style. • Cohesive evaluation of language, form and structure. • Understanding of the relationship between text and context is integrated convincingly into the response. • Discriminating use of relevant examples in support.

Question number	Indicative content
12 <i>Romeo and Juliet</i>	Examiners should be alert to a variety of responses and should reward points that are clearly based on evidence from the play. Evidence of a degree of personal response must be given. This is not an exhaustive list but the following points may be made: (AO1) • Shakespeare explores the positive aspects of love, as well as the difficulties when relationships are incompatible. Different types of love are presented: romantic, parental and that of friends, and how the older and younger generations approach love • the audience sees an obsessive love from Romeo. He is initially infatuated with Rosaline, but she does not return his love. Once he sees Juliet he quickly switches affections to her and believes he has truly fallen in love. An even greater obsession then begins: 'I ne'er saw true beauty till this night' • Romeo and Juliet immediately have an all-encompassing love for each other. It is by far the most important thing in their lives and they are willing to give up everything for it: 'Romeo, doff thy name', 'Take all myself' • Shakespeare shows the power of traditional romantic love to shape the lives of Romeo and Juliet and lead to tragedy. Such is the power of their love that they risk their parents' fury to marry in secret and be together. Juliet bravely declares 'O Romeo, Romeo! Wherefore art thou Romeo? / Deny thy father and refuse thy name; / or, if thou wilt not, be but sworn my love, / And I'll no longer be a Capulet' • a different type of love is shown in Juliet's close relationship with the Nurse, which contrasts with the distant relationship she has with her mother. Lady Capulet knows very little about her daughter, whereas the Nurse can speak at length about Juliet's life. Juliet seeks her advice in her secret marriage to Romeo and lets her make arrangements. The Nurse tells her 'hie you to Friar Lawrence's cell, / There stays a husband to make you a wife' • the Friar displays a caring relationship with Romeo. He is not convinced by Romeo's love for Juliet at first and thinks it is infatuation like he felt for Rosaline: 'Young men's love then lies not truly in their hearts, but in their eyes'. However, he is prepared to marry them in secret to try to heal the rift between their families • family love and honour are shown to be important when Romeo refuses to fight Tybalt after he is married to Juliet, as it makes them related by family: 'Tybalt, the reason that I have to love thee / Doth much excuse the appertaining rage / To such a greeting'. By declaring his love for Tybalt, Romeo shows he now realises the importance of family ties • the power of friendship is shown in the relationship between Benvolio and Romeo. As his cousin, Benvolio sees it as his role to be peacemaker when he tries to stop the fighting in the street at the beginning of the play: 'Put up your swords!' He is also the one Romeo's parents ask when checking on Romeo's welfare • in contrast, Romeo's friendship with Mercutio tends to lead him into trouble. Mercutio's insistence on fighting Tybalt leads to Romeo's feeling

	the need to avenge his friend's death. He realises that it is his efforts to stop the fight between Tybalt and Mercutio that have led to Mercutio's death: 'I thought all for the best'. This guilt leads to his pursuing Tybalt in blind rage and killing him • Shakespeare finally shows the healing power of love as the death of both Romeo and Juliet forces an end to hostilities between the Montagues and Capulets. (AO2) • Language: Romeo roams the streets with his friends and uses oxymorons and hyperbolic language to describe his obsessive love for Rosaline: 'Feather of lead, bright smoke, cold fire, sick health', 'This love feel I' • Language/Form: Juliet's words early in the play are ironic and foreshadow events to come later in the play: 'My grave is like to be my wedding bed'. She suspects that their love might be doomed • Form: Juliet's premonitions of death and her realisation that she has fallen in love with a Montague reflects the way that fate controls events: 'Prodigious birth of love it is to me, / that I must love a loathed enemy' • Form/Structure: from the opening prologue the audience knows that Romeo and Juliet must die to end the feud between their families. We know their love is doomed and this shadow of death overhangs the play and raises the dramatic tension • Structure: ancient family conflict between the Montagues and Capulets is the backdrop to the tragedy. It is shown to overwhelm people's lives and affect the love affair of Romeo and Juliet. (AO4) • in Shakespearean times people tended to get married at a much younger age than today. It was normal to be married by the age of 13 and parents would also usually choose the spouse for their child. This shows how strongly Romeo and Juliet felt about each other to go against tradition in this way • Shakespeare wrote love sonnets in which he defines true love as the 'marriage of true minds' (<i>Sonnet 116</i>). He warned against infatuation which is about physical attraction only • despite arranged marriages, one myth about romantic love in Elizabethan England was that everyone had 'another half' that they were constantly searching for.
--	--

Level	Mark	AO1 Demonstrate a close knowledge and understanding of texts, maintaining a critical style and presenting an informed personal engagement. (10 marks) AO2 Analyse the language, form and structure used by a writer to create meanings and effects. (10 marks) AO4 Show understanding of the relationships between texts and the contexts in which they were written. (10 marks)
	0	No rewardable material.
Level 1	1–6	• Limited knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response is simple with little evidence of personal engagement or critical style. • Minimal identification of language, form and structure. • There is little comment on the relationship between text and context. • Limited use of relevant examples in support.
Level 2	7–12	• Some knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response may be largely narrative with some evidence of personal engagement or critical style. • Some comment on the language, form and structure. • There is some comment on the relationship between text and context. • Some use of relevant examples in support.
Level 3	13–18	• Sound knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response shows relevant personal engagement and an appropriate critical style. • Sound understanding of language, form and structure. • There is relevant comment on the relationship between text and context. • Use of clearly relevant examples in support.
Level 4	19–24	• Thorough knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response shows thorough personal engagement and a sustained critical style. • Sustained analysis of language, form and structure. • There is a detailed awareness of the relationship between text and context. • Use of fully relevant examples in support.
Level 5	25–30	• Assured knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response shows assured personal engagement and a perceptive critical style. • Cohesive evaluation of language, form and structure. • Understanding of the relationship between text and context is integrated convincingly into the response. • Discriminating use of relevant examples in support.

Question number	Indicative content
13 <i>Macbeth</i>	Examiners should be alert to a variety of responses and should reward points that are clearly based on evidence from the play. Evidence of a degree of personal response must be given. This is not an exhaustive list but the following points may be made: (AO1) • candidates are free to agree or disagree, wholly or in part, with the view that Macbeth's downfall was brought on by his own ambition. Responses should be assessed on the arguments presented • Macbeth has no notion of becoming king until the Witches meet him on his return from the battleground and give him the prophecy that he 'shalt be King hereafter'. Once he starts to believe that the Witches might be telling him the truth, he starts to change in his attitude towards life and his character becomes more secretive and calculating: 'False face must hide what false heart doth show' • Macbeth says in his soliloquy, after learning of the Witches' prophecy: 'I have no spur / To prick the sides of my intent, but only / Vaulting ambition'. He realises that ambition is his only motive in killing King Duncan and that he is trying to 'o'er-leap' himself by planning the murder • Macbeth has proved himself to be a very brave and loyal warrior as one of the leaders of King Duncan's army. In a recent battle with the Norwegians, the Sergeant reports to Duncan: 'brave Macbeth – well he deserves that / name'. If he goes ahead with the murder of Duncan, he will lose men's good opinion of him. He values his reputation as a loyal person and is pleased with Duncan's praise and rewards • however, when he tells his wife, Lady Macbeth 'We will proceed no further in this business', she accuses him of being a 'coward' and a 'beast' for going back on their agreement, which makes him change his mind. This shows how powerful his wife is in persuading him to be ambitious • after the murder of Duncan, Macbeth becomes paranoid, feeling he cannot trust anyone. His brief reign as king is not successful as he spends more time worrying about his enemies than his country and his people. His feelings of guilt are shown clearly in the banquet scene when the murderers he hired to kill his friend Banquo appear at the door and he is plagued by the ghost of Banquo whom he thinks he sees at the table: 'never shake / Thy gory locks at me' • Macbeth embarks on a killing spree, trying to rid himself of anyone on whom he feels he needs to take revenge, such as Macduff and his family. His ambition to be king has turned him into a villain, which turns out to be fatal for him • when Macbeth starts to doubt his safety as king, he returns to the Witches for reassurance. He realises that there is no way back for him now as his ambition has led him down the road of tyranny and bloodshed: 'I am in blood / Stepp'd in so far, that, should I wade no more, / Returning were as tedious as go o'er' • Shakespeare shows this extreme ambition leads to murder and madness for the individual and tyranny for the whole country. When Macbeth learns that his ambition is false and that the Witches have tricked him, he realises that he has brought on his own tragic fate: 'be these juggling fiends no more believ'd'

- candidates may decide that the influence of Lady Macbeth and the Witches fuel Macbeth's ambition and that he would not carry out the murder without their goading. In this respect he may not be considered entirely to blame for his downfall
- Shakespeare does show some positive examples of ambition in the play to contrast the way in which Macbeth used his ambition wrongly. Macduff and Malcolm, for example, are driven by the ambition to rid Scotland of Macbeth and restore the true heir to the throne but their actions restore the natural order and, unlike Macbeth, they do not try to change their fate.

(AO2)

- Language: Macbeth uses metaphor to explain that the praises he has earned are like new clothes that he wants to wear: 'I have bought / Golden opinions from all sorts of people, / Which would be worn now in their newest gloss'. The adjective 'golden' has connotations of being valuable to him
- Language: Lady Macbeth uses persuasive techniques, questioning Macbeth's manliness and ambition when he says he will not murder Duncan: 'When you durst do it, then you were a man; / And, to be more than what you were, you would / Be so much more the man'
- Form: the audience can see Macbeth's ambitious thoughts through his soliloquies, where he shares his inner secrets and doubts without the other characters hearing
- Form: as a tragedy, the play shows the downfall of a respected man brought on by his own weakness. The events of the play speed up in its final acts, and Macbeth once again takes action in fighting against Malcolm's army, reverting to the strong and brave warrior that he always has been
- Structure: Macbeth's overwhelming ambition is one of the 'fatal flaws' of his tragic character. The 'fatal flaw' is the fundamental weakness in a character's personality that leads to his/her downfall. All this links closely to themes of the supernatural and order versus disorder.

(AO4)

- Jacobean and Elizabethan beliefs in the medieval Chain of Being in which everyone has their hierarchical place in the world. By killing King Duncan, Macbeth has upset the natural order and this has affected the weather
- the medieval idea of noble kingship would be based on a legitimate king who derived loyalty from his subjects. He would rule well and in the interests of the kingdom and his subjects. Macbeth is not the rightful king and would be seen to bring the tragedy on himself
- overall, Shakespeare suggests that some ambition is good. Medieval nobles were right to strive to be strong warriors and to maintain power. Extreme ambition outside the natural order, however, is shown to be terrible for everyone.

Level	Mark	AO1 Demonstrate a close knowledge and understanding of texts, maintaining a critical style and presenting an informed personal engagement. (10 marks) AO2 Analyse the language, form and structure used by a writer to create meanings and effects. (10 marks) AO4 Show understanding of the relationships between texts and the contexts in which they were written. (10 marks)
	0	No rewardable material.
Level 1	1–6	• Limited knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response is simple with little evidence of personal engagement or critical style. • Minimal identification of language, form and structure. • There is little comment on the relationship between text and context. • Limited use of relevant examples in support.
Level 2	7–12	• Some knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response may be largely narrative with some evidence of personal engagement or critical style. • Some comment on the language, form and structure. • There is some comment on the relationship between text and context. • Some use of relevant examples in support.
Level 3	13–18	• Sound knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response shows relevant personal engagement and an appropriate critical style. • Sound understanding of language, form and structure. • There is relevant comment on the relationship between text and context. • Use of clearly relevant examples in support.
Level 4	19–24	• Thorough knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response shows thorough personal engagement and a sustained critical style. • Sustained analysis of language, form and structure. • There is a detailed awareness of the relationship between text and context. • Use of fully relevant examples in support.
Level 5	25–30	• Assured knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response shows assured personal engagement and a perceptive critical style. • Cohesive evaluation of language, form and structure. • Understanding of the relationship between text and context is integrated convincingly into the response. • Discriminating use of relevant examples in support.

Question number	Indicative content
14 <i>Macbeth</i>	Examiners should be alert to a variety of responses and should reward points that are clearly based on evidence from the play. Evidence of a degree of personal response must be given. This is not an exhaustive list but the following points may be made: (AO1) • sleep is a significant motif in the play, such as Duncan is murdered as he sleeps and later Lady Macbeth sleepwalks • sleep is presented as a gift from nature and the ability to sleep well is connected to innocence and peace: 'the innocent sleep, / Sleep that knits up the ravell'd sleeve of care'. Being unable to sleep is a sign of guilt and a tormented conscience • after he has murdered Duncan, Macbeth says that he has 'murdered sleep', which has a double meaning: he has killed a sleeping man and he has also killed his own serenity. He is tormented by nightmares, never again being able to sleep peacefully • Lady Macbeth suggests that he should put the matter out of his thoughts but from this point on, sleep becomes something the Macbeths crave. They desire to sleep more than anything, but once Duncan is murdered, sleep eludes them • Duncan is murdered in his sleep and not given the chance to defend himself, which is a dishonourable way of killing someone: 'Methought I heard a voice cry, "Sleep no more!" ' Macbeth realises that killing the king while he is sleeping is a dreadful thing to do, especially as the king is in line to God: 'I am afraid to think what I have done' • the Guards are drugged and given an induced sleep on the night of Duncan's murder. They cry out in their sleep as if they have a premonition that something is wrong: 'There's one did laugh in 's sleep, and one cried 'Murder!' • the inability to sleep symbolises the inescapable guilt Lady Macbeth and Macbeth feel. The dead are viewed as lucky to 'sleep' and not suffer mentally as Macbeth and his wife must. When Macbeth starts to have hallucinations of Banquo's ghost, Lady Macbeth blames his lack of rest: 'You lack the season of all natures, sleep' • in the second half of the play, Lady Macbeth walks in her sleep and repeatedly acts out the murder. She loses control as the play continues. She descends into madness and feels alone, seemingly consumed by guilt for her crimes, leading to her eventually taking her own life in order to find eternal sleep • by utilising the sleeping Duncan as a figure of purity in sleep, Shakespeare presents the absence of rest through the cruel murder by Macbeth. The motif of sleep is used to depict the overall message and inevitable result of the traitorously foul acts that are committed throughout this play. (AO2) • Language: Shakespeare uses the metaphor of sleep to show loss of innocence and guilt. Once Macbeth realises the enormity of his crime, he realises that 'Macbeth shall sleep no more'

	• Language: when Duncan's body is discovered, Macduff describes sleep as an imitation and compares it with eternal slumber. He tells Banquo to wake up: 'Shake off this downy sleep, death's counterfeit, / And look on death itself!' • Form: Shakespeare uses sleep both as a reward and as a consequence. If a character is innocent and pure, he is allowed restful, fulfilling sleep • Form: different types of sleep are shown in the play: drugging with wine, peaceful slumber, nightmares, sleepwalking and death. Each is used for a different purpose to show how sleep can be both innocent and full of torment • Structure: by the end of the tragedy, the only thing both Macbeth and his wife long for is eternal sleep and death. Lady Macbeth takes her own life, which would be deemed cowardly by some, but Macbeth restores some honour by fighting to the last as the warrior he always should be. Both die and find rest from their guilt. (AO4) • Jacobean and Elizabethan believed in the Divine Right of Kings, which meant that Duncan was God's representative on Earth. To kill the king was not only treason but an act against God and the natural order • James I came to the throne in a period of political unrest when he took an active part in pursuing witches. Castles became places of bloodshed usually through family blood feuds. Often, deaths occurred in open combat but the deaths in <i>Macbeth</i>, which occur at Glamis and Fife, are murders engineered by Macbeth • Duncan was murdered in his sleep, which means he had no chance to prepare himself for the afterlife by making his confession. Catholics would consider that his soul might, therefore, be rejected from heaven.
--	--

Level	Mark	AO1 Demonstrate a close knowledge and understanding of texts, maintaining a critical style and presenting an informed personal engagement. (10 marks) AO2 Analyse the language, form and structure used by a writer to create meanings and effects. (10 marks) AO4 Show understanding of the relationships between texts and the contexts in which they were written. (10 marks)
	0	No rewardable material.
Level 1	1–6	• Limited knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response is simple with little evidence of personal engagement or critical style. • Minimal identification of language, form and structure. • There is little comment on the relationship between text and context. • Limited use of relevant examples in support.
Level 2	7–12	• Some knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response may be largely narrative with some evidence of personal engagement or critical style. • Some comment on the language, form and structure. • There is some comment on the relationship between text and context. • Some use of relevant examples in support.
Level 3	13–18	• Sound knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response shows relevant personal engagement and an appropriate critical style. • Sound understanding of language, form and structure. • There is relevant comment on the relationship between text and context. • Use of clearly relevant examples in support.
Level 4	19–24	• Thorough knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response shows thorough personal engagement and a sustained critical style. • Sustained analysis of language, form and structure. • There is a detailed awareness of the relationship between text and context. • Use of fully relevant examples in support.
Level 5	25–30	• Assured knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response shows assured personal engagement and a perceptive critical style. • Cohesive evaluation of language, form and structure. • Understanding of the relationship between text and context is integrated convincingly into the response. • Discriminating use of relevant examples in support.

Question number	Indicative content
15 <i>The Merchant of Venice</i>	Examiners should be alert to a variety of responses and should reward points that are clearly based on evidence from the play. Evidence of a degree of personal response must be given. This is not an exhaustive list but the following points may be made: (AO1) • candidates are free to choose any character in the play who they feel has heroic qualities. The play has multiple characters who could be considered heroes, including Antonio, Portia, and Shylock, but they all have weaknesses that could be seen to diminish this role • Antonio could be considered a hero as he is a wealthy and respected merchant of the play's title. Antonio is known for his generosity and love for his friend Bassanio, and he is willing to do anything to help him, even if it means risking his own life. Antonio starts the play's main conflict when he accepts Shylock's terms for a loan to help Bassanio court Portia • however, Antonio's treatment of Shylock shows anti-Semitic attitudes, which might be viewed less favourably by a modern audience. He calls Shylock 'misbeliever, cut-throat dog' and tells him 'I am as like to call thee so again, / To spit on thee again, to spurn thee too', even though Bassanio wants to borrow money from him with Antonio as his security. When Antonio's argosies are lost at sea and he cannot repay the money Bassanio owes Shylock, he must pay the forfeit and has to rely on others to free him from his bond • Portia could be considered a hero for impersonating a lawyer to save Antonio from Shylock's contract. She finds a loophole in the agreement, which saves Antonio's life, by telling Shylock that he can take his pound of flesh, but he cannot spill any blood: 'prepare thee to cut off the flesh. / Shed thou no blood, nor thou less or more / But just a pound of flesh' • however, although she proves powerful at the end of the play, she is shown to be a victim in the first half, being helplessly bound by her father's will only to marry the successful suitor in the riddle of the caskets. When she describes her recent suitors she shows a bigoted attitude towards foreigners, describing the Prince of Morocco as having 'the complexion of a devil'. Her attitude towards Shylock in court later in the play shows that she has little regard for the fact that Antonio entered into the bond with Shylock willingly and that Shylock is actually just in his claim, however inhuman his demands seem • Shylock is a Jewish moneylender with a forceful personality who shows his devotion to his beliefs in the trial scene. Some consider Shylock an antihero because he follows dangerous and uncivilised human behaviours, and he indirectly tries to kill Antonio with his fatal bond. However, others say that Shylock is the play's antagonist because he is positioned as such, even though he may seem to be helping Antonio and Bassanio at first

- a modern audience could view Shylock more favourably, and candidates could argue that he has suffered years of mistreatment in Venice at the hands of other businessmen like Antonio, and that he is justified in wanting to make the arrogant Antonio pay what he agreed to in the bond: 'You call'd me dog', 'Is it possible / A cur can lend three thousand ducats?'
- Bassanio might be viewed as the hero because he chose the right casket in Belmont and freed Portia from her imprisonment. He did this by choosing 'meagre lead', which could show that he is a good and honest man, not just wanting riches: 'So may the outward shows be least themselves: / The world is still deceiv'd with ornament'
- however, it could be argued that Bassanio benefits from good luck and having the right friends, such as Antonio, who, it is hinted, has lent him money unwisely in the past. Also, some may question his motives in courting Portia having described her as 'a lady richly left'. Although Portia calls him 'her lord, her governor, her king', she is a much stronger character than him and she is the one who must sort out the problems that his friend Antonio has got himself into.

(AO2)

- Language: Shylock is victimised and subject to verbal insults throughout the play, showing his lack of power and respect: 'cut-throat dog', 'dog Jew', 'wolf'. In contrast Antonio shows loyal and heroic qualities when he says 'I have engaged myself to a dear friend' and will not let Bassanio down
- Language: throughout the play, Shylock is only referred to by his name six times. Most people refer to Shylock as 'the Jew', which shows he is not accepted by society or considered a hero. In contrast, other characters are treated with respect: Solanio introduces Bassanio to Antonio as 'your most noble kinsman'
- Language: Antonio's language is laced with sadness and regret when he realises that Shylock has the right to claim what is his. He accepts his painful fate using a metaphor: 'For if the Jew do cut but deep enough, / I'll pay it presently with all my heart'
- Form: blank verse changes to prose in Shylock's 'Hath not a Jew eyes?' speech to convey how impassioned he is about the treatment of Jews
- Form: the play could be viewed as a tragedy, focusing on the collapse of the Jewish moneylender, Shylock, who exits the stage a wrecked man and is forced at the conclusion of the play to become a Christian and to surrender his assets. This could possibly lead to him being seen as a tragic hero
- Structure: the plot hinges on Antonio's plight, which could make him the hero of the play. But it could be argued that Shakespeare affords him a quiet sadness that prevents him from taking dramatic focus away from the major characters
- Structure: it appears that the play will have a tragic ending for Antonio but the heroic actions of Portia in court provide a turning point in the play. Antonio is given a happy outcome as he does not have to give his life to pay

	his debt. He thanks Portia at the end of the play: 'Sweet lady, you have given me life and living'.
--	--

(AO4)

- | | |
|--|---|
| | <ul style="list-style-type: none">• a Shakespearean audience was likely to have anti-Semitic views so would have seen Shylock as a villain because of his religion• in Shakespeare's time, prejudice about skin colour was evident in society and is considered in his other plays such as <i>Othello</i>• Jews were suspected of being mean and covetous because of their practice of usury (lending money and charging interest)• the Italian setting and plot of <i>The Merchant of Venice</i> are typical of Shakespeare's early comedies, but the inclusion of Antonio's sad and loyal character lends an air of pathos and gravity to the drama, which may make the play more of a tragi-comedy. |
|--|---|

Level	Mark	AO1 Demonstrate a close knowledge and understanding of texts, maintaining a critical style and presenting an informed personal engagement. (10 marks) AO2 Analyse the language, form and structure used by a writer to create meanings and effects. (10 marks) AO4 Show understanding of the relationships between texts and the contexts in which they were written. (10 marks)
	0	No rewardable material.
Level 1	1–6	• Limited knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response is simple with little evidence of personal engagement or critical style. • Minimal identification of language, form and structure. • There is little comment on the relationship between text and context. • Limited use of relevant examples in support.
Level 2	7–12	• Some knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response may be largely narrative with some evidence of personal engagement or critical style. • Some comment on the language, form and structure. • There is some comment on the relationship between text and context. • Some use of relevant examples in support.
Level 3	13–18	• Sound knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response shows relevant personal engagement and an appropriate critical style. • Sound understanding of language, form and structure. • There is relevant comment on the relationship between text and context. • Use of clearly relevant examples in support.
Level 4	19–24	• Thorough knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response shows thorough personal engagement and a sustained critical style. • Sustained analysis of language, form and structure. • There is a detailed awareness of the relationship between text and context. • Use of fully relevant examples in support.
Level 5	25–30	• Assured knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response shows assured personal engagement and a perceptive critical style. • Cohesive evaluation of language, form and structure. • Understanding of the relationship between text and context is integrated convincingly into the response. • Discriminating use of relevant examples in support.

Question number	Indicative content
16 The Merchant of Venice	Examiners should be alert to a variety of responses and should reward points that are clearly based on evidence from the play. Evidence of a degree of personal response must be given. This is not an exhaustive list but the following points may be made: (AO1) • revenge is a very significant theme in the play: it is shown as a powerful, corrupting, and destructive force. Shylock wants to hurt Antonio because of Shylock's desire for revenge against the entire Christian community, which he blames for persecuting and degrading him: 'And if you wrong us, shall we not revenge?' • Shylock feels deeply pained by the inequality he suffers in Venetian society where he is as successful a businessman as Antonio without the respect. He says when a Jew offends a Christian, the reaction is revenge. So, if a Christian offends a Jew, the punishment that the Jew will come up with, if he follows this example, is revenge. Shylock says that Christians have set an example of wickedness and cruelty. Therefore, Shylock wishes to take greater revenge on the Christian, Antonio • Shylock explains that he would rather take Antonio's flesh than money to pay his debt because such an act would give him the revenge he has always wanted. Solanio voices concern as he believes no one can stop Shylock or deter him from his need for revenge: 'It is the most impenetrable cur / that ever kept with men' • significant acts of revenge are further examined with reference to financial wealth and its role in driving revenge. Shylock seeks revenge on Lorenzo for stealing his daughter and the money she took when she ran away: 'My daughter! O my ducats! O my daughter!' The loss of his money seems as upsetting to him as the loss of his daughter. Shylock's hatred of Antonio also seems to be connected to money: 'I hate him for he is a Christian, / But more for that in low simplicity / He lends out money gratis and brings down / The rate of usance here with us in Venice' • at the end of the play, Portia punishes Shylock severely in court once she has outwitted his plot for vengeance through the bond. She takes revenge on him further by pointing out another aspect of Venetian law: if any foreigner (Shylock, as a Jew, is a foreigner) seeks directly or indirectly the life of any citizen of Venice, then one half of his estate goes to the party whose death he contrives and the other half to the state • Antonio gives his half of Shylock's wealth to Lorenzo and Jessica by making them beneficiaries in Shylock's will. He then makes Shylock convert to Christianity to exact further revenge on him. Shylock is forced to agree and leaves the court a broken man: 'I am not well' • the final significant act of revenge is more of a playful one to lighten the mood of the play and ensure a happy ending. Portia, as Balthazar, says she will take no money for her services but insists that Bassanio should give her his ring, which he has promised Portia he will never part with. She and Nerissa trick their husbands into parting with their rings and watch them try to explain later.

(AO2)

- Language: in Shylock's 'Hath not a Jew eyes?' speech, his use of the pronouns in his plea for fair treatment, 'If you prick us, do we not bleed?', shows how he blames his desire for revenge directly on how Christians treat him: 'The villainy you teach me I will execute'
- Language: towards the end of the play, when Antonio has been arrested for debt, Shylock uses repetition to emphasise his determination to get justice and revenge: 'I'll have my bond, speak not against my bond; / I have sworn an oath that I will have my bond'
- Form: though some describe *The Merchant of Venice* as a comedy because it ends with the marriage of its heroes Portia and Bassanio, it can also be described as a revenge tragedy. Typically, a revenge tragedy revolves around the quest of its central character to avenge a wrong
- Form/Structure: the dramatic climax of the play is the trial scene, which culminates with an insight into the outcome of revenge in the context of another central theme, mercy
- Structure: in the first half of the play, the action moves between two settings: Venice and Belmont. In this way Shakespeare can advance both the parallel plots of Antonio and Shylock, and Portia and Bassanio, before bringing them together in the second half of the play
- Structure: once Portia has defeated Shylock, that plot is over, and Shakespeare introduces a new one where the wives test their husbands' loyalties, taking playful revenge on them for parting with their precious rings. This is so that the play does not end on a bitter note.

(AO4)

- by setting the play in 16th-century Venice, Shakespeare creates competitive characters in a flourishing, mercantile environment that enables revenge to thrive and be explored in the play
- by juxtaposing the theme of wealth and anti-Semitism, which was rife in Venice at the time, Shakespeare gives Shylock's reason for revenge depth and purpose
- the laws regarding an 'alien' in Venice plotting the murder of a citizen apply to Shylock because he is Jewish even though he is a resident. A resident Christian would not receive such harsh treatment.

Level	Mark	AO1 Demonstrate a close knowledge and understanding of texts, maintaining a critical style and presenting an informed personal engagement. (10 marks) AO2 Analyse the language, form and structure used by a writer to create meanings and effects. (10 marks) AO4 Show understanding of the relationships between texts and the contexts in which they were written. (10 marks)
	0	No rewardable material.
Level 1	1–6	• Limited knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response is simple with little evidence of personal engagement or critical style. • Minimal identification of language, form and structure. • There is little comment on the relationship between text and context. • Limited use of relevant examples in support.
Level 2	7–12	• Some knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response may be largely narrative with some evidence of personal engagement or critical style. • Some comment on the language, form and structure. • There is some comment on the relationship between text and context. • Some use of relevant examples in support.
Level 3	13–18	• Sound knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response shows relevant personal engagement and an appropriate critical style. • Sound understanding of language, form and structure. • There is relevant comment on the relationship between text and context. • Use of clearly relevant examples in support.
Level 4	19–24	• Thorough knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response shows thorough personal engagement and a sustained critical style. • Sustained analysis of language, form and structure. • There is a detailed awareness of the relationship between text and context. • Use of fully relevant examples in support.
Level 5	25–30	• Assured knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response shows assured personal engagement and a perceptive critical style. • Cohesive evaluation of language, form and structure. • Understanding of the relationship between text and context is integrated convincingly into the response. • Discriminating use of relevant examples in support.

Question number	Indicative content
17 <i>Pride and Prejudice</i>	Examiners should be alert to a variety of responses and should reward points that are clearly based on evidence from the novel. Evidence of a degree of personal response must be given. This is not an exhaustive list but the following points may be made: (AO1) • the theme of marriage is important in the novel. This is exemplified by the opening statement of the novel: 'It is a truth universally acknowledged, that a single man in possession of a good fortune, must be in want of a wife' • when Mr Bingley moves to Netherfield, Mrs Bennet exclaims 'Oh! Single, my dear, to be sure! A single man of large fortune; four or five thousand a year. What a fine thing for our girls'. Mrs Bennet understands the importance of marrying well in order to maintain a high standing in society: 'The business of her life was to get her daughters married' • as Mrs Bennet's character develops, the reader recognises that her obsession with the marriage of her daughters has adverse consequences, and directly affects her desperate behaviour in public. She shamelessly turns any conversation to her daughters to get them noticed • Mrs Bennet's desperation is especially noticeable when Elizabeth is given the opportunity to marry Mr Collins, a distant cousin, who as the result of entailment will inherit Mr Bennet's property. After learning of Elizabeth's refusal to marry Mr Collins, she implores Mr Bennet to force Elizabeth to change her mind. In her final efforts to convince Elizabeth, Mrs Bennet tells her 'If you take it into your head to go on refusing every offer of marriage in this way, you will never get a husband at all' • readers can understand Mrs Bennet's aggravating personality when they realise her actions stem from a place of worry for her daughters' future. Since Mrs Bennet is a woman, she can provide no other form of security but marriage for her daughters. Compared to other men during this period, Mr Bennet has done little to give his daughters a financially sound future, so she feels she must act to improve their prospects • Charlotte Lucas is entirely devoted to winning a man who will provide her financial security. According to her, happiness in marriage is 'entirely a matter of chance'. Charlotte's idea of marriage to Mr Collins is presented not as a culmination of love, feelings and emotions, but as a strictly followed plan. Marriage for her is 'the only honourable provision for well-educated young women of small fortune' • Jane is the oldest and prettiest of the sisters but is stoical about her disappointment in love when she believes Mr Bingley does not return her affections, and her lack of confidence almost ruins her chances of a happy marriage. Hers is a gentle and unassuming romance, not the tempestuous affair of her sister, Elizabeth, with Mr Darcy • later in the novel, Mrs Bennet supports Lydia's reckless marriage to George Wickham because he is outwardly charming, but the enforced marriage is 'unsettled to the extreme' because of his deceit and the fact that Mr Darcy must support the couple financially

	- Elizabeth, the protagonist of the novel, refuses to do what is expected of her and wants to marry for love, not wealth. She turns down Mr Darcy's initial proposal, viewing him as 'the proudest, most disagreeable man in the world'. Elizabeth is portrayed as expressing liberal feminist ideas of marriage. She believes that affection, friendship and respect are major elements of a happy and strong marriage; she rejects the notion that one should marry for wealth or social status - the novel represents two main types of marriage: the result of strong feelings and attraction, or ambitions for higher social status and financial security. Jane Austen makes it clear that acting on the passion of the moment is not a firm foundation for a happy and lasting marriage. (AO2) - Language: Mrs Bennet speaks excitedly when discussing her daughters' prospective husbands. She sets aside Mr Wickham's faults as she is simply delighted that Lydia is married: 'Mrs Wickham! How well it sounds!' - Language: Mr Collins' lengthy proposal of marriage to Elizabeth is, like his letters, verbose and focused on practicality and his sense of his own importance: 'it is usual with young ladies to reject the addresses of the man whom they secretly mean to accept' - Form/Structure: Jane Austen introduces the concepts of marriage and financial wealth as important. Throughout the novel, Austen depicts various relationships that exhibit these two recurring themes - Structure: Mr Wickham acts as the catalyst for the novel's climax when he runs away with Lydia. Elizabeth says 'My younger sister has left all her friends – has eloped; has thrown herself into the power of – of Mr Wickham' - Structure: the story's resolution suggests that marriage is better if built on a loving relationship, but this is not always the most important consideration. (AO4) - during the Regency period, when the novel is set, the social status and wealth of men were of principal importance for women - Jane Austen critiques a society built upon gender roles by examining the obstacles women experienced. She shows how women were controlled by men through their need to get married - the females of the family were forced to marry because they did not inherit any wealth. The Bennet family is forced to comply with the same boundaries Austen was governed by when she grew up - although Mr Bennet realises that he is not well-suited to his wife, divorce was very rare and was confined to the upper classes at the time Austen was writing. Divorce would have been a big scandal for a family.
--	---

Level	Mark	AO1 Demonstrate a close knowledge and understanding of texts, maintaining a critical style and presenting an informed personal engagement. (10 marks) AO2 Analyse the language, form and structure used by a writer to create meanings and effects. (10 marks) AO4 Show understanding of the relationships between texts and the contexts in which they were written. (10 marks)
	0	No rewardable material.
Level 1	1–6	• Limited knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response is simple with little evidence of personal engagement or critical style. • Minimal identification of language, form and structure. • There is little comment on the relationship between text and context. • Limited use of relevant examples in support.
Level 2	7–12	• Some knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response may be largely narrative with some evidence of personal engagement or critical style. • Some comment on the language, form and structure. • There is some comment on the relationship between text and context. • Some use of relevant examples in support.
Level 3	13–18	• Sound knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response shows relevant personal engagement and an appropriate critical style. • Sound understanding of language, form and structure. • There is relevant comment on the relationship between text and context. • Use of clearly relevant examples in support.
Level 4	19–24	• Thorough knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response shows thorough personal engagement and a sustained critical style. • Sustained analysis of language, form and structure. • There is a detailed awareness of the relationship between text and context. • Use of fully relevant examples in support.
Level 5	25–30	• Assured knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response shows assured personal engagement and a perceptive critical style. • Cohesive evaluation of language, form and structure. • Understanding of the relationship between text and context is integrated convincingly into the response. • Discriminating use of relevant examples in support.

Question number	Indicative content
18 <i>Pride and Prejudice</i>	Examiners should be alert to a variety of responses and should reward points that are clearly based on evidence from the novel. Evidence of a degree of personal response must be given. This is not an exhaustive list but the following points may be made: (AO1) • Mr Fitzwilliam Darcy is presented at first as a proud and arrogant man, particularly to those that he considers of lower social status, but the way he is viewed by others changes during the novel. He is a member of the old Anglo-Norman aristocracy, as indicated by his own name as well as that of his aunt, Lady Catherine de Bourgh • at the Meryton assembly, he does not dance with any ladies outside his own party because he believes them to be beneath him in class and beauty: 'there is not another woman in the room whom it would not be a punishment to me to stand up with' • later on, he admits to Elizabeth Bennet that he does not find it easy to make new acquaintances and to converse with people he does not know. This shows a sort of shy, perhaps even reclusive, nature in Mr Darcy that is not illustrated before this point in the novel • his motives for his behaviour, when he advises Charles Bingley not to marry Jane Bennet, are brotherly. He believes that he is rescuing him from a bad marriage. Later, he learns that his judgement and actions were misguided. He realises that his prejudice towards Jane was wrong and changes his mind about the marriage • Mr Darcy's arrogance is seen in his first proposal to Elizabeth whereby he acts more with pride than in a loving manner: 'In vain I have struggled. It will not do. My feelings will not be repressed'. He is angry when she rejects him as his pride is wounded: 'His complexion became pale with anger, and the disturbance of his mind was visible in every feature' • however, Mr Darcy's attitude changes, and his determined stance is shown by the way he pursues Elizabeth despite her rejection of his first offer of marriage, demonstrating the depth of his feelings that he often has trouble expressing properly. Through Elizabeth, he learns to be less boastful and arrogant because he realises that his actions have deeply affected others • after receiving Mr Darcy's letter of explanation, Elizabeth notes that she has never 'seen anything that betrayed him to be unprincipled or unjust – anything that spoke him of irreligious or immoral habits; that among his own connections he was esteemed and valued'. Despite the way in which Elizabeth often mocks him, she is surprised by his gallantry as he persists in pursuing her • on her visit to Mr Darcy's residence, Elizabeth is impressed by Pemberley's gardens, hills, forests, fields, valleys, streams and pastures, all of which show Mr Darcy's commitment to appreciating the beauty of nature. His servants have only good things to say about their master, and her uncle, Mr Gardiner, tells her 'He is perfectly well-behaved, polite and unassuming'

- George Wickham's irresponsible elopement with Lydia allows Mr Darcy to demonstrate the caring side of his character. He now feels responsible for Mr Wickham's continued bad behaviour through his silence: if he had made Mr Wickham's bad character known, Lydia would have been safe. Mr Darcy chooses to involve himself in arranging Lydia's marriage, risking his own reputation to save her honour
- Elizabeth's feelings for Mr Darcy are a sign of her intellectual growth: as she comes to understand that first impressions can be wrong, so he comes to realise the value of love. She changes his outlook throughout the novel, but he also helps her to mature and be less impulsive.

(AO2)

- Language: at one point, Mr Darcy states 'disguise of every sort is my abhorrence', reflecting the fact he never pretends to be anything other than he is
- Language: Mr Darcy's speech shows his social status through his educated vocabulary. He tells Mr Bingley 'I am by no means convinced that you would be gone with such celerity'
- Language/Form: even though Mr Darcy is sometimes clumsy at expressing his love for Elizabeth, his tendency to speak only what he really feels stands in marked contrast to the polished words of Mr Wickham, who never means what he says
- Language/Form: Mr Darcy wears the standard dress of a Regency gentleman, described as 'a darkly coloured, double-collared coat over a waistcoat together with breeches and riding boots in the day and darkly coloured tailcoat, light breeches or dark trousers in the evening'
- Language/Structure: Austen presents pride as an ugly characteristic: Mr Darcy's 'manners gave a disgust which turned the tide of his popularity; for he was discovered to be proud; to be above his company'. He has to overcome this to be happy with Elizabeth
- Structure: at first, Mr Darcy displays outrageous arrogance to Elizabeth, but the novel ends with him as a man who admits to having been 'selfish and overbearing', which shows the power of love to tame excessive pride. His manner has changed significantly by the end of the novel because of his love for Elizabeth.

(AO4)

- Mr Darcy reflects the changing standards of English masculinity in the new Romantic age as, unlike the heroes of the 18th century with their excessive politeness and unwillingness to offend, Mr Darcy says whatever he likes, which shows his authenticity and honesty
- in the Romantic age, those who prefer the 'authentic' world of the outdoors are seen as the more sincere and passionate in their emotions. Mr Darcy's preference for being in his garden and in the grounds of the estate at Pemberley shows him as a Romantic hero
- at the time of the French Revolution, when the elite all over Europe felt threatened, there was a tendency in British literature to glorify the aristocratic classes and gentry as the personification of British values in contrast to the French who guillotined their old elite.

Level	Mark	AO1 Demonstrate a close knowledge and understanding of texts, maintaining a critical style and presenting an informed personal engagement. (10 marks) AO2 Analyse the language, form and structure used by a writer to create meanings and effects. (10 marks) AO4 Show understanding of the relationships between texts and the contexts in which they were written. (10 marks)
	0	No rewardable material.
Level 1	1–6	• Limited knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response is simple with little evidence of personal engagement or critical style. • Minimal identification of language, form and structure. • There is little comment on the relationship between text and context. • Limited use of relevant examples in support.
Level 2	7–12	• Some knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response may be largely narrative with some evidence of personal engagement or critical style. • Some comment on the language, form and structure. • There is some comment on the relationship between text and context. • Some use of relevant examples in support.
Level 3	13–18	• Sound knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response shows relevant personal engagement and an appropriate critical style. • Sound understanding of language, form and structure. • There is relevant comment on the relationship between text and context. • Use of clearly relevant examples in support.
Level 4	19–24	• Thorough knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response shows thorough personal engagement and a sustained critical style. • Sustained analysis of language, form and structure. • There is a detailed awareness of the relationship between text and context. • Use of fully relevant examples in support.
Level 5	25–30	• Assured knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response shows assured personal engagement and a perceptive critical style. • Cohesive evaluation of language, form and structure. • Understanding of the relationship between text and context is integrated convincingly into the response. • Discriminating use of relevant examples in support.

Question number	Indicative content
19 Great Expectations	Examiners should be alert to a variety of responses and should reward points that are clearly based on evidence from the novel. Evidence of a degree of personal response must be given. This is not an exhaustive list but the following points may be made: (AO1) - the title, <i>Great Expectations</i>, is significant because it suggests the main message of the novel. The protagonist, Pip (Philip Pirrip), has great expectations of becoming a gentleman, thereby becoming a worthy husband for the beautiful Estella. Pip is described as 'a young man of great expectations' because he is expected to come into a large sum of money - Pip was born an orphan and hand-raised by his sister, Mrs Joe, and her husband, Joe Gargery. Pip has the expectation of Estella's falling in love with him and this leads to Pip's wanting to become a gentleman: '... but I think that I always wanted to be a gentleman' - the initial suggestion of Pip's expectations comes from Mr Jaggers, Miss Havisham's lawyer. The link between Mr Jaggers and Miss Havisham leads Pip to believe that Miss Havisham wants him to improve his social standing so that he can marry Estella. He tells Biddy 'I want to be a gentleman on her [Estella's] account' - therefore, when Mr Jaggers informs Pip of his great fortune, he automatically expects his benefactor to be Miss Havisham: 'the communication I have got to make is that he has Great Expectations ... He will come into handsome property ... immediately removed from his present sphere of life and from this place and be brought up as a gentleman ... as a young fellow of great expectations'. When he later learns that his benefactor is the convict he helped on the marshes as a boy, he is devastated - the result of Pip's great expectations is anything but 'great'. His desire of being a gentleman leads Pip to reject his childhood home at the forge and to value those things in life that are ultimately unimportant, such as money and social class - however, the title has a wider application to a number of other characters in the story: Herbert aspires to secure a respectable position and to marry; Mr Wopsle parodies the expectations of Pip in his ridiculous hopes of becoming a serious actor; Pumblechook parodies Pip's excessive expectations in his claim to having brought about Pip's success. Some may consider that Mr Wemmick's exaggerated home, the castle, displays a lightly comical image of a great expectation - Miss Havisham, who had great expectations of a happy life, was jilted on her wedding day and has spent the rest of her life in limbo, seeking revenge on all men through her adopted daughter, Estella. In the end she seeks to regain some peace of conscience with Pip's forgiveness - even though Estella is the daughter of the convict Magwitch, she is adopted into a higher class by Miss Havisham as a child and later marries a nobleman, Bentley Drummle. Estella represents dissatisfaction despite upward mobility: 'I have been bent and broken, but – I hope – into a better shape' - Estella's words to Pip mirror his experiences. This bending and breaking has been happening his whole life. The difference here is that she is embracing it.

	Pip never could embrace his circumstances. He continues with great expectations and his life feels unfulfilled • Biddy is in love with Pip before he leaves for London to become a gentleman. However, before she can discuss her feelings for him, Pip confides in her his love for Estella. After rejection by Estella, Pip expects he can just go back and Biddy will be ready to marry him. However, he discovers she has now found happiness in marrying Joe • Magwitch is the only character who could be said to achieve more than his expectations. As a convict transported to New South Wales, he had nothing, but hopes to redeem his tragic life by using his hard-earned money to make Pip a gentleman, which he achieves: 'Yes, Pip, dear boy, I've made a gentleman on you!' • at the end of the novel, Pip learns that loyalty and compassion are more important than wealth and social standing, but unlike other characters who have come to terms with unexpected outcomes, Pip still has expectations. (AO2) • Language: the title is a significant metaphor for Pip's aspirations and the societal pressure to rise above one's class and have 'great' success • Language: character names often reflect their traits and roles: Pip's name suggests something small that will grow, symbolising his personal development; Miss Havisham's name hints at her stagnant, decaying life (have a sham); Estella's name, meaning 'star', reflects her unattainable nature • Form: the novel is a bildungsroman that follows Pip's growth from childhood to adulthood. We see Pip change his point of view many times as he matures, which is significant to the novel's message • Form/Structure: the title is ironic because the protagonist, Pip, fails to achieve most of his great expectations • Structure: the very first paragraph introduces Pip, the narrator of this autobiographical novel. This immediately engages our interest in the central character with 'great expectations'. (AO4) • at the time the novel was written, money was seen as power. Dickens uses the novel to show that money does not necessarily bring happiness, through his depiction of the miserable lives of Miss Havisham and Estella • in the novel, Pip seeks a better life through education, influenced by meeting Estella. Dickens himself sought self-advancement through education • Pip's journey from poverty to a wealthy gentleman, making friends from different classes, was unusual. This highlighted Dickens' desire for social change.
--	--

Level	Mark	AO1 Demonstrate a close knowledge and understanding of texts, maintaining a critical style and presenting an informed personal engagement. (10 marks) AO2 Analyse the language, form and structure used by a writer to create meanings and effects. (10 marks) AO4 Show understanding of the relationships between texts and the contexts in which they were written. (10 marks)
	0	No rewardable material.
Level 1	1–6	• Limited knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response is simple with little evidence of personal engagement or critical style. • Minimal identification of language, form and structure. • There is little comment on the relationship between text and context. • Limited use of relevant examples in support.
Level 2	7–12	• Some knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response may be largely narrative with some evidence of personal engagement or critical style. • Some comment on the language, form and structure. • There is some comment on the relationship between text and context. • Some use of relevant examples in support.
Level 3	13–18	• Sound knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response shows relevant personal engagement and an appropriate critical style. • Sound understanding of language, form and structure. • There is relevant comment on the relationship between text and context. • Use of clearly relevant examples in support.
Level 4	19–24	• Thorough knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response shows thorough personal engagement and a sustained critical style. • Sustained analysis of language, form and structure. • There is a detailed awareness of the relationship between text and context. • Use of fully relevant examples in support.
Level 5	25–30	• Assured knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response shows assured personal engagement and a perceptive critical style. • Cohesive evaluation of language, form and structure. • Understanding of the relationship between text and context is integrated convincingly into the response. • Discriminating use of relevant examples in support.

Question number	Indicative content
20 Great Expectations	Examiners should be alert to a variety of responses and should reward points that are clearly based on evidence from the novel. Evidence of a degree of personal response must be given. This is not an exhaustive list but the following points may be made: (AO1) • Miss Havisham urges Pip to love Estella: ‘Love her, love her, love her!’ Candidates’ views as to the extent that Pip comes to love Estella will vary. Responses should be assessed on the arguments presented • Pip, as a young boy, falls in love with Estella when he meets her on a visit to Satis House arranged by Mr Pumblechook. Estella views Pip as a ‘common labouring boy’ and emphasises his poor background by humiliation: ‘what coarse hands he has’. Her approach to Pip is cold and disdainful from the start and continues throughout the novel • Pip becomes ashamed of his background and relatives after falling in love with Estella, which changes his perspective of life owing to attraction towards Estella’s lifestyle. Pip’s love for Estella is at the heart of his restlessness. Once he has seen Estella, he can never be happy again because of his desire for her • Estella warns Pip that she cannot love him or anyone else. Estella rejects Pip’s love because she does not understand what it means to love someone: ‘ “You must know,” said Estella, condescending to me as a brilliant and beautiful woman might, “that I have no heart” ’ • he continues to harbour intense love for Estella, though he has been warned that Estella has been brought up by Miss Havisham to inspire unrequited love in the men around her, to avenge the latter’s disappointment at being jilted on her wedding day. Miss Havisham raised Estella as a weapon to repay every man, including Pip, for their unkind treatment of her • Miss Havisham tells Pip he must suffer if he loves Estella: ‘ “I’ll tell you”, said she, in the same hurried passionate whisper, “what real love is. It is blind devotion, unquestioning self – humiliation, utter submission, trust and belief against yourself and against the whole world, giving up your whole heart and soul to the smiter – as I did!” ’ • Estella may truly love Pip but does not have the ability to develop these feelings, so instead she chooses to let him go. She struggles to understand why she does the things that she does, but only knows how to interact with others based on how she was raised by Miss Havisham. After her disastrous marriage and abuse at the hands of Bentley Drummle, she is even more emotionally fragile • Pip’s love for Estella is never going to be easy as they are both flawed individuals: Pip has let his supposed fortune go to his head, and Estella has been listening to Miss Havisham’s hatred of men. It could be argued that, by the end of the novel, they have both become aware of their flaws and the damage that has been caused, so could make each other happy • on the other hand, there is a lot standing in the way of their love. Estella is a widow, who has been abused, and Miss Havisham’s opinion of men has had a lot of evidence to support it. Estella feels like she cannot love anybody and is

	prepared to walk away from Pip. Pip still seems unable to face up to reality and become a true friend to Estella, which is a prerequisite to any sort of love • Charles Dickens seemed unsure himself as to whether Pip truly loves Estella and whether they should have a future together, which is why he wrote two endings: one where the couple part, and the other, which hints that they will stay together and grow more confident in each other's company: 'I saw no shadow of another parting from her'. (AO2) • Language: Estella's name means 'star', which suggests that her beauty shines out from others' but she is unreachable • Language: anaphora is used to emphasise Pip's feelings towards Estella: 'I loved her against reason, against promise, against hope, against happiness, against all discouragement that could be' • Language: Miss Havisham's repeated words to Estella: 'Break their hearts ... break their hearts and have no mercy', reflect her understanding of emotional suffering and Pip's mistaken beliefs about her intentions for him to marry Estella • Language/Structure: Pip uses images of nature to describe his love for Estella: 'You have been in every prospect I have ever seen – on the river, on the sails of the ships, on the marshes, in the clouds'. This use of symbolism is used again at the end of the novel when Satis House is in ruins and the young couple return to it on the brink of beginning again • Language/Structure: at the end of the novel, Estella uses metaphorical language to reflect on how she has grown and learned from her experiences in life: 'I have been bent and broken, but – I hope – into a better shape' • Form: as Pip is the narrator, the events of the novel are told from his perspective. This facilitates the reader's first-hand account of the influences in Pip's life and his feelings about Estella • Structure: the ending of the novel is left deliberately ambiguous so that readers can make up their own minds as to whether Pip's love for Estella will last. (AO4) • as it is a romantic novel, some readers may prefer the revised ending where it is possible that Pip and Estella find happiness together: the plot might feel more complete as Pip finds happiness with the daughter of the man he helped years before • love was not strictly a requirement for Victorian marriage so a contemporary reader may not have seen the problem of Pip's future happiness with Estella as that important • Dickens had a difficult relationship with his own mother, which is perhaps reflected by the portrayal of some of the female characters in the novel, particularly in the depiction of the menacing Mrs Joe and the cruel Miss Havisham.
--	--

Level	Mark	AO1 Demonstrate a close knowledge and understanding of texts, maintaining a critical style and presenting an informed personal engagement. (10 marks) AO2 Analyse the language, form and structure used by a writer to create meanings and effects. (10 marks) AO4 Show understanding of the relationships between texts and the contexts in which they were written. (10 marks)
	0	No rewardable material.
Level 1	1–6	• Limited knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response is simple with little evidence of personal engagement or critical style. • Minimal identification of language, form and structure. • There is little comment on the relationship between text and context. • Limited use of relevant examples in support.
Level 2	7–12	• Some knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response may be largely narrative with some evidence of personal engagement or critical style. • Some comment on the language, form and structure. • There is some comment on the relationship between text and context. • Some use of relevant examples in support.
Level 3	13–18	• Sound knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response shows relevant personal engagement and an appropriate critical style. • Sound understanding of language, form and structure. • There is relevant comment on the relationship between text and context. • Use of clearly relevant examples in support.
Level 4	19–24	• Thorough knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response shows thorough personal engagement and a sustained critical style. • Sustained analysis of language, form and structure. • There is a detailed awareness of the relationship between text and context. • Use of fully relevant examples in support.
Level 5	25–30	• Assured knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response shows assured personal engagement and a perceptive critical style. • Cohesive evaluation of language, form and structure. • Understanding of the relationship between text and context is integrated convincingly into the response. • Discriminating use of relevant examples in support.

Question number	Indicative content
21 <i>The Scarlet Letter</i>	Examiners should be alert to a variety of responses and should reward points that are clearly based on evidence from the novel. Evidence of a degree of personal response must be given. This is not an exhaustive list but the following points may be made: (AO1) • candidates are free to agree or disagree, partially or wholly, with the view that Reverend Arthur Dimmesdale is the 'one sinner of the world'. Responses should be assessed on the arguments presented • Dimmesdale makes this confession at the end of the novel when he is giving his sermon by the scaffold and reveals that he is the father of Pearl • at the beginning of the novel, he is described as having 'large, melancholy eyes and a tremulous mouth', suggesting great sensitivity. An ordained Puritan minister, he is well educated, and he has a philosophical turn of mind. There is no doubt that he is devoted to God, passionate in his religion, and effective in the pulpit • however, Dimmesdale represents the pain of secret sin, especially because he is a minister who is supposed to represent morality for his community. He has had a secret affair with Hester Prynne and is the father of her illegitimate child, Pearl. He has kept this secret for seven years, but the guilt of it has been destroying his physical health so that he grows thin and weak. He beats himself with a bloody whip and keeps frequent all-night vigils during which his mind is plagued by frightening visions • Dimmesdale could be considered hypocritical and self-centered because he knows his sins but cannot confess them, leaving Hester as a shamed woman and an outcast. Hester is imprisoned and punished cruelly for her sin, but he has kept his good reputation. Dimmesdale goes through most of the novel without confessing his sin and it is mentally killing him. In the end, Dimmesdale changes from being unsupportive of Hester to being remorseful to God: 'God's eye beheld it!' • it could be claimed that he is not the 'one sinner' in the novel. There are others who could also be accused of sinning, like Hester herself. As a married woman, she entered into an adulterous affair with a church minister, knowing the strict views of the Puritanical society she had joined. She could be accused of being reckless and not marrying for love. She travelled away from her family, first to Amsterdam and then, without her husband, to the New World • Roger Chillingworth could also be viewed as a sinner. He is called 'the leech' because he sucks the spirit and strength from Dimmesdale the way the aquatic leech exploits and often kills its host. He pretends to be a caring physician, but he attaches himself to Dimmesdale so that he can wreak his revenge: 'I shall seek this man, as I have sought truth in books'. His motivation seems to be mainly jealousy because he knows Hester never loved or desired him • the novel explores different types of sin: adultery and weak morality, and hatred and vengeance. Both Dimmesdale and Hester are guilty of the first. Dimmesdale dies as a result of his confession because of the weight of the guilt, and Hester spends her life carrying the sign of the scarlet letter 'A' on her chest to mark her shame. However, the affair has given her Pearl, a wonderful child, and makes her much stronger in the end. It could be argued that Chillingworth has committed the greatest sin because he lets himself be ruled by hatred and the consuming desire for vengeance. (AO2)

- Language: Chillingworth's sin corrupts him, and he becomes malicious after discovering Hester's adultery: 'at first, his expression had been calm, meditative, scholar-like. Now there was something ugly and evil in his face'
- Language/Structure: Dimmesdale's sin is central to the novel's action. A metaphor is used to emphasise the nature of his inner conflict: 'a terrible machinery had been brought to bear, and was still operating, on Mr Dimmesdale's well-being and repose'
- Form/Structure: redemption is a crucial part of the novel's message. Dimmesdale is redeemed in death because of his confession. It is a tension in the narrative that he does not do this sooner
- Form/Structure: the novel's psychological focus explores the nature of sin and its impact on the lives of individuals
- Structure: the scarlet letter that is sewn to Hester's clothing is symbolic of sin, which can never be taken away
- Structure: the novel explores themes of sin, guilt, and judgement, and how they can affect a person's life. Hawthorne suggests that sin is not just the act itself, but also the judgement, guilt and vengeance that follow.

(AO4)

- a relationship out of wedlock was deeply shocking to Puritan societies of America in the 1600s. Adultery was a sin and a punishable crime
- Hester's defiance and strength would likely have been considered exceptional to a contemporary reader of Hawthorne's work
- Puritan ministers were expected to be stainless in their conduct and reputation.

Level	Mark	AO1 Demonstrate a close knowledge and understanding of texts, maintaining a critical style and presenting an informed personal engagement. (10 marks) AO2 Analyse the language, form and structure used by a writer to create meanings and effects. (10 marks) AO4 Show understanding of the relationships between texts and the contexts in which they were written. (10 marks)
	0	No rewardable material.
Level 1	1–6	- Limited knowledge and understanding of the text. - The response is simple with little evidence of personal engagement or critical style. - Minimal identification of language, form and structure. - There is little comment on the relationship between text and context. - Limited use of relevant examples in support.
Level 2	7–12	- Some knowledge and understanding of the text. - The response may be largely narrative with some evidence of personal engagement or critical style. - Some comment on the language, form and structure. - There is some comment on the relationship between text and context. - Some use of relevant examples in support.
Level 3	13–18	- Sound knowledge and understanding of the text. - The response shows relevant personal engagement and an appropriate critical style. - Sound understanding of language, form and structure. - There is relevant comment on the relationship between text and context. - Use of clearly relevant examples in support.
Level 4	19–24	- Thorough knowledge and understanding of the text. - The response shows thorough personal engagement and a sustained critical style. - Sustained analysis of language, form and structure. - There is a detailed awareness of the relationship between text and context. - Use of fully relevant examples in support.
Level 5	25–30	- Assured knowledge and understanding of the text. - The response shows assured personal engagement and a perceptive critical style. - Cohesive evaluation of language, form and structure. - Understanding of the relationship between text and context is integrated convincingly into the response. - Discriminating use of relevant examples in support.

Question number	Indicative content
22 The Scarlet Letter	Examiners should be alert to a variety of responses and should reward points that are clearly based on evidence from the novel. Evidence of a degree of personal response must be given. This is not an exhaustive list but the following points may be made: (AO1) - religious faith is a very important theme in the novel as it affects the lives of all the characters - the novel is set in Puritan New England and is full of Christian references and religious beliefs. The novel depicts Puritan culture, including the idea that people should live by the word of God and face severe punishment if they transgress. The Puritans believed that the devil was behind every evil deed - the people of Salem are ruled by Christian doctrines, such as sin, morality, confession, guilt, heaven and hell. The Puritans believed that Satan's most powerful tool was his ability to tempt, deceive and beguile people. Forgiveness was rare for those who committed sin, and repentance was long and full of suffering - Reverend Arthur Dimmesdale, as the town's minister, is the person who is supposed to uphold the community's religious and moral standards. However, he is the most important example of religious hypocrisy in the novel. The people believe him to be so good that, if he were to die, it would be because 'the world was not worthy to be any longer trodden by his feet', but he has secretly committed adultery - Hester Prynne has suffered for seven years for her sin of adultery, but her religious belief is genuine and important to her. Even though she has committed a sin in a moment of weakness, she strives to be a good Christian. She gives much back to the people of the town, but she is ostracised and made to live in isolation on its outskirts. Even after her imprisonment and years of shame through being forced to wear the scarlet letter 'A', it appears that she will never be shown forgiveness by them: 'They should have put a brand of a hot iron on Hester Prynne's forehead' - she warns her daughter, Pearl, not to commit sin like she did: 'Once in my life I met the Black Man', 'This scarlet letter is his mark!' Hester is a caring person and a good mother to Pearl. She bears no malice against those who judge her and treat her badly. By humanising Hester, Hawthorne is able to convey the unrealistic religious standards the Puritans try to maintain - the Governors, Richard Bellingham and John Winthrop, and the Ministers, John Wilson and Arthur Dimmesdale, work together to uphold the religious doctrines of the town. Although Dimmesdale tries to make them be more lenient in letting her keep Pearl, the other three are shown to be cold and unforgiving in their treatment of Hester and her illegitimate child. In contrast, Mistress Hibbins' communion with the Black Man in the forest is tolerated for several years - at the end of the novel, Hester repents what she has done, but by voluntarily resuming her letter 'A', she shows her willingness to be responsible for it in her later life. However, she comes to view her sin to be far from evil. Hester's character matures so that she questions everything she has learned as a woman in the Puritan faith

- the novel celebrates individual faith, showing that the inner faith of a person is more important than the external decree of a religious doctrine.

(AO2)

- Language: the adjective 'scarlet' has connotations of wantonness and sexual desire, which is the opposite of what is expected by her religion
- Language: there is use of pathetic fallacy in the novel to reflect the importance of Dimmesdale's suffering and feelings: the terrible storm on the night he stands on the scaffold and the midday brightness that illuminates his full confession
- Language/Form: Hester believes that many people have sins to share, but they are not carrying these around on their chest as a physical manifestation of shame: '... if truth were everywhere to be shown, a scarlet letter would blaze forth on many a bosom'
- Form: the novel includes many Biblical allusions from the Old Testament, such as the idea that adulterers should die. This punitive approach forms an important part of the community's religious faith
- Form: Massachusetts Bay Colony, Boston, is a fictional colony but is used by Hawthorne to represent a dystopian universe within the text, so could be viewed as a timeless setting
- Structure: like the red 'A' on Hester's clothes, Pearl herself is symbolic of her mother's shame. Hester even dresses her in a crimson velvet tunic when she goes to see Governor Bellingham. Pearl does not recognise her mother without her scarlet letter
- Structure: the novel portrays the Puritan views about the dangerous nature of sins, but at the same time shows Hester as a heroine for adhering to her own more genuine religious faith.

(AO4)

- Hawthorne takes a romantic view that everyone finds their own truth in life and that virtue is found by living within one's own conscience. It is not religious faith that should define the individual
- Hawthorne criticises the hypocrisy of the external religious institution as he depicts the corruption and moral weakness of Dimmesdale. He uses the novel as an allegory to show the adverse effects of strict religious beliefs
- Hawthorne himself never committed to any religious faith. He rejected both the Puritanism his ancestors were devoted to, and Catholicism, which was criticised and rebuked in the early United States during Hawthorne's lifetime.

Level	Mark	AO1 Demonstrate a close knowledge and understanding of texts, maintaining a critical style and presenting an informed personal engagement. (10 marks) AO2 Analyse the language, form and structure used by a writer to create meanings and effects. (10 marks) AO4 Show understanding of the relationships between texts and the contexts in which they were written. (10 marks)
	0	No rewardable material.
Level 1	1–6	• Limited knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response is simple with little evidence of personal engagement or critical style. • Minimal identification of language, form and structure. • There is little comment on the relationship between text and context. • Limited use of relevant examples in support.
Level 2	7–12	• Some knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response may be largely narrative with some evidence of personal engagement or critical style. • Some comment on the language, form and structure. • There is some comment on the relationship between text and context. • Some use of relevant examples in support.
Level 3	13–18	• Sound knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response shows relevant personal engagement and an appropriate critical style. • Sound understanding of language, form and structure. • There is relevant comment on the relationship between text and context. • Use of clearly relevant examples in support.
Level 4	19–24	• Thorough knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response shows thorough personal engagement and a sustained critical style. • Sustained analysis of language, form and structure. • There is a detailed awareness of the relationship between text and context. • Use of fully relevant examples in support.
Level 5	25–30	• Assured knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response shows assured personal engagement and a perceptive critical style. • Cohesive evaluation of language, form and structure. • Understanding of the relationship between text and context is integrated convincingly into the response. • Discriminating use of relevant examples in support.